

NAMIBIA 2026

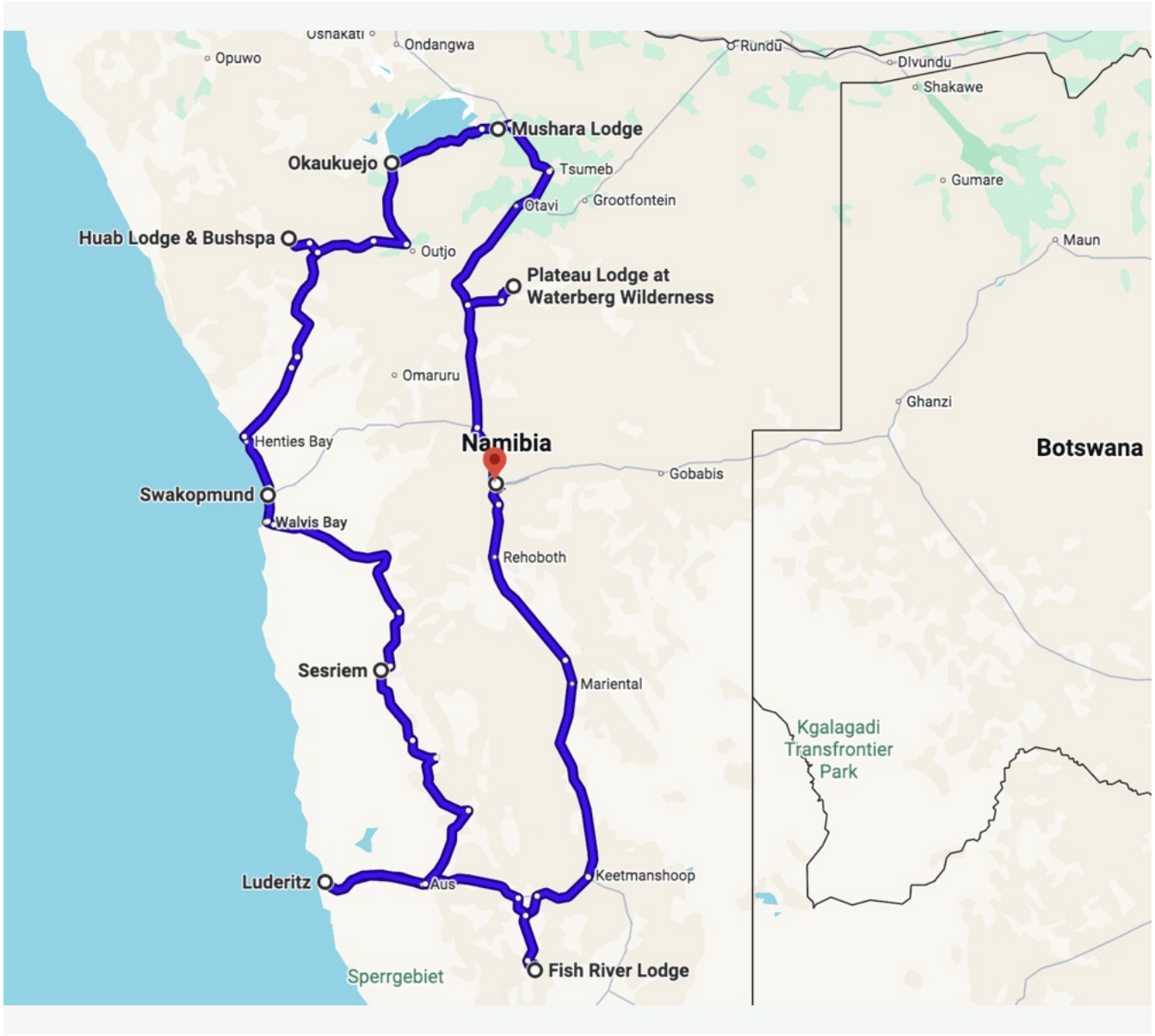
Roadbook · Far Gravel

A crossing from the Kalahari to the Waterberg

24 July – 16 August 2026

The trip in numbers

A crossing from south to north, designed to balance road, landscape and time to explore



FAR GRAVEL

24 days

from 24 July to 16 August

23 nights

with several two-night stays

approx. 4,020 km

planned; actually more with safaris and detours

2 4x4s

range, fridges and kitchen

13 base camps

from the Kalahari to the Waterberg

INDEX

Itinerary and index

Where each day and each appendix of the roadbook is

Day 1	24 Jul	Hotel Thule	9
Day 2	25 Jul	Kalahari Anib	11
Day 3	26 Jul	Kalahari Anib	13
Day 4	27 Jul	Fish River	15
Day 5	28 Jul	Fish River	17
Day 6	29 Jul	Desert Horse Inn	19
Day 7	30 Jul	Desert Horse Inn	21
Day 8	31 Jul	BüllsPort	23
Day 9	1 Aug	BüllsPort	25
Day 10	2 Aug	Sossus Dune	27
Day 11	3 Aug	Swakopmund	29
Day 12	4 Aug	Swakopmund	31
Day 13	5 Aug	Spitzkoppe	33
Day 14	6 Aug	Spitzkoppe	35
Day 15	7 Aug	Huab	37
Day 16	8 Aug	Huab	39
Day 17	9 Aug	Okaukuejo	41
Day 18	10 Aug	Okaukuejo	43
Day 19	11 Aug	Mushara	45
Day 20	12 Aug	Waterberg	47
Day 21	13 Aug	Waterberg	49
Day 22	14 Aug	Daan Viljoen	51
Day 23	15 Aug	Daan Viljoen	53
Day 24	16 Aug	Departure	55

APPENDICES

Approximate Costs · p.62 **Budget · p.64** **Trip Checklist · p.65** **Packing Checklist · p.66** **First Supermarket Shop · p.68** **Communication · p.69**

GUIDE

How to use this roadbook

A page to get the most out of the guide on the road

THE STRIP AT THE TOP OF EACH DAY

Six quick-reference fields: sunrise/sunset; temperature; base distance (km); departure time (recommended and maximum); the day's aim; and accommodation with board basis — BB (bed and breakfast), DBB (with dinner) or SC (self-catering).

FUEL & SUPPLIES SECTION — 2ND PAGE

On applicable days it shows, in one place, the meals to buy and the recommended diesel (with the approximate distance to the next pump). It is the logistical summary of the day.

MAPS AND NAVIGATION

Each driving day includes a mini-map and the list of essential waypoints, in the actual order of the trip. The special maps of Sossusvlei and Etosha are in the appendices.

FOOTER AND APPENDICES

The footer of each day shows the date, the current base and the next base. The appendices gather costs, parks and permits, checklists, first purchase, useful words and emergency contacts.

12 HIGHLIGHTS

The great moments · 1/2

Images to anticipate the trip



01 **Kalahari**



02 **Fish River Canyon**



03 **Kolmanskop**



04 **BüllsPort**



05 **Sossusvlei**



06 **Sandwich Harbour**

The great moments · 2/2

Images to anticipate the trip



07 **Living Desert**



08 **Spitzkoppe**



09 **Damaraland**



10 **Etosha**



11 **Waterberg**



12 **The light of Namibia**

A country shaped by distance

Landscape, history and human diversity before starting the road



ANCIENT LANDSCAPES AND OPEN HORIZONS

Namibia is one of the least densely populated countries in the world. Between the coast Atlantic and the Kalahari, the trip crosses ancient deserts, plateaus, escarpments, savannahs and rivers that stay dry for much of the year. The scale is part of the experience: the changes landscape changes slowly, making the road as important as the destinations.

A COMPLEX HISTORY

The San, Khoekhoe, Damara, Nama, Herero, Ovambo and many other peoples lived in this territory centuries before German colonisation began at the end of the 19th century. The domination colonial rule and the genocide against Herero and Nama left deep marks. After South African administration and a long liberation struggle, Namibia became independent on 21 March 1990.

ONE COUNTRY, MANY VOICES

English is the official language, but daily life is deeply multilingual. Afrikaans often works as a common language, while Oshiwambo, Khoekhoegowab, Otjiherero, RuKwangali and other languages reflect identities distinct regions. The trip alternates between towns, private properties, parks national and small towns: observing and talking helps to understand the country beyond the landscapes.



Travel well in Namibia

Pace, light and self-sufficiency make the trip safer and more interesting



LIGHT SETS THE DAY

In winter, sunrise and sunset set the pace. Mornings can be very cold; in the late afternoon, the light transforms dunes, mountains and savannahs. The roadbook shows a recommended departure time and, on days of drive, a time limit that protects arrival in daylight.

ROADS AND DISTANCES

Tarmac covers the main routes, but many stages use gravel. The speed should adapt to the surface, dust and visibility. Refuel early, keep water accessible and accept that a photo stop takes longer than planned are part of the plan.

SELF-SUFFICIENCY WITHOUT TURNING THE TRIP INTO AN OPERATION

The 4x4s with fridge and kitchen allow picnic lunches in remote places. The goal is not to carry everything from Windhoek, but to buy in cycles: Windhoek, Keetmanshoop, Lüderitz, Swakopmund and Outjo serve as the main points of restock. The roadbook only highlights the purchases that condition the days following.

WHAT MAKES THIS TRIP PERSONAL

The route combines unmissable places with room for decisions on the spot: a short walk, an unexpected viewpoint, time at a waterhole or a conversation in a small town. The alternatives appear alongside the day on which can really be chosen, without turning every possibility into obligations.

DAY 1

24 July — Arrival in Windhoek

Hosea Kutako International Airport → AfriCar → Hotel Thule

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	FLIGHT	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:29 / 18:28	6–9 °C / 20–23 °C	DT573 · arrival 12:30	Lift and check both 4x4s	Hotel Thule – BB

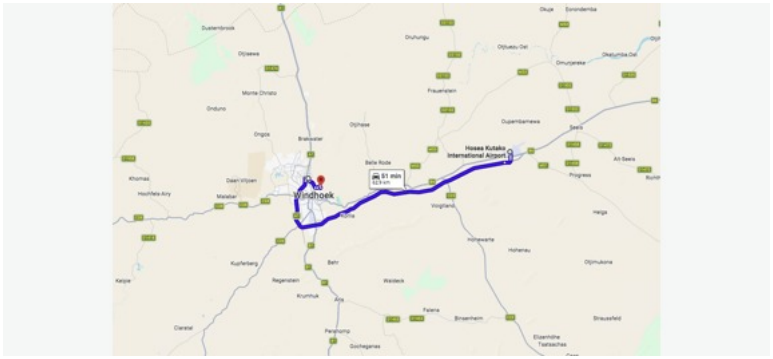
DAY BRIEFING

Today is not a day to visit Windhoek or do big shopping. The aim is to land, handle formalities, collect and carefully check the two 4x4s and reach Hotel Thule with time to rest.

DAY PLAN

12:30	**Landing** Immigration, luggage and entry formalities.
13:15–14:15	**Airport** MTC SIM cards, only if the counter is open and without delaying the transfer.
14:15–15:00	**AfriCar transfer** Meet the representative and head to Windhoek.
15:00–17:30	**4x4 handover** Full briefing and check of each vehicle.
until 18:00	**Hotel Thule** Check-in, hand over luggage and keep documents safe.
19:00	**Dinner** Hotel restaurant or a simple solution, depending on the group's energy.





DAY 1

Prepare the 4x4s and recover from the journey

The success of remote days begins with an unhurried vehicle handover

THE REAL PRIORITY

A problem identified in Windhoek is simple to solve; the same problem on a remote road can take several hours. At least one responsible person per 4x4 should know the equipment and test the vehicle before leaving AfriCar.

CHECK IN EACH 4x4

- Photograph exterior, interior, tyres, glass and existing damage.
- Confirm fuel, diesel type and return policy.
- Test the fridge, sockets and food with the engine on and off.
- Locate spare tyres, jack, wheel spanner, compressor and gauge.
- Confirm kitchen, cutlery, chairs, tables and 24-hour assistance.
- Pair the radios and do a short test drive.

MEALS AND SHOPPING

Do not do the main shopping today. Buy only water, snacks or any missing essentials. For dinner, the restaurant of Hotel Thule is the simplest plan; Joe's Beerhouse is an option if everyone has energy.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

2407-01	**Hosea Kutako International Airport**	-22.487344, 17.463793
2407-02	**AfriCar · 7 Tienie Louw Street**	-22.534778, 17.074127
2407-03	**Hotel Thule Windhoek**	-22.552328, 17.098131
optional	**Joe's Beerhouse**	-22.550906, 17.090342

DAY 2

25 July — From Windhoek to the red sands of the Kalahari

Hotel Thule → Maerua SUPERSPAR → Rehoboth → Kalahari Anib Lodge

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:29 / 18:21	min 4–7 °C · max 22–25 °C	285 km	Recommended 08:15 Max. 11:30	Logistical supplies for the trip and arrival at Kalahari.	Kalahari Anib Lodge – DBB

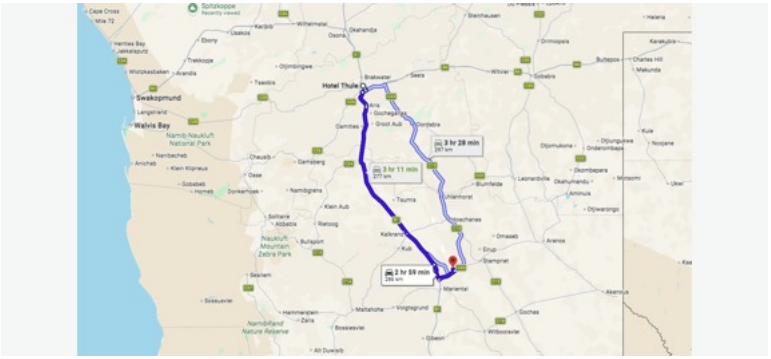
DAY BRIEFING

Today the road trip truly begins. The morning is devoted to fuelling both 4x4s, organising the fridges and buying the durable consumables and provisions for the stage. Then we follow the B1 to the Kalahari, watching the landscape become progressively more open and reddish. The essential thing is to leave Windhoek with everything resolved and arrive at the lodge with time to slow down.

DAY PLAN

07:30	**Hotel Thule** Breakfast included
08:15	**Departure** Check-out and quick check of the 4x4s
08:30–10:00	**Maerua SUPERSPAR** Main shopping, distribution between the 4x4s and organisation of the fridges
10:00–10:30	**Windhoek** Fill up both vehicles completely
10:30–11:00	**B1 south** Start the journey to Rehoboth
12:00–13:00	**Rehoboth / Lake Oanob** Picnic lunch; choose the option according to departure time
13:00–16:00	**B1 → C20** Drive to Kalahari Anib Lodge
15:00–16:00	**Lodge** Check-in and rest
late afternoon	**Kalahari** Free short walk, if there is still daylight and energy
dinner	**Lodge** Included in the DBB plan





DAY 2

First shop and departure from Windhoek

25 July — From Windhoek to the red sands of the Kalahari

HOTEL THULE → MAERUA SUPERSPAR

A short trip into town for the most important purchase of the first stage. The supermarket opens on Saturdays at opens at 07:30 and has a bakery, butcher, fresh produce and a café. Besides the durable items on the first-purchase list, buy provisions for 3 self-catering lunches: 25, 26 and 27 July.

OPTION A · LAKE OANOB RESORT

Lake Oanob sits by a dam surrounded by hills, a few kilometres west of Rehoboth. It is the alternative picturesque place for the first picnic lunch and should have toilets and resort services.

WINDHOEK REHOBOTH · B1 .

Leaving the capital crosses the hills south of Windhoek before opening into wider landscapes. The B1 is paved, but the usual precautions still apply: safe distance, attention to animals and avoid unnecessary overtaking.

REHOBOTH KALKRAND C20 DETOUR

Continue on the B1 towards Mariental. The stretch becomes progressively more rural and open. About 10–12 km before Mariental, turn east on the C20 towards Stampriet. Critical navigation: do not continue to Mariental via distraction. Confirm the C20 detour on the GPS before leaving Rehoboth.

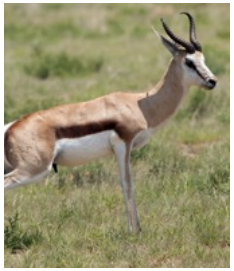
FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Buy 3 lunches (25–27 Jul); no dinners — lodges on half board.
Diesel	Fill up the 4x4s in Windhoek. Next reliable pump: Keetmanshoop, ~480 km (day 27); top-up possible in Rehoboth.

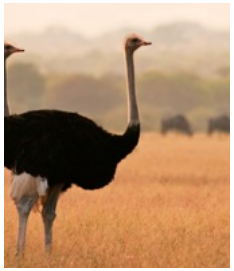
FAUNA OF THIS TERRITORY



Gemsbok



Springbok



Ostrich

ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0108P-01	**Hotel Thule Windhoek** -22.552328, 17.098131
2507-02	**Maerua SUPERSPAR** -22.584917, 17.091877
2507-05	**Lake Oanob Resort** -23.323817, 17.017367
2507-08	**B1 / M29 junction in Mariental, then continue to the C20 and Stampriet** -24.628049, 17.955331
2507-09	**Kalahari Anib Lodge** -24.430000, 18.100833

DAY 3

26 July — A day among the Kalahari dunes

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:27 / 18:21	min 3–7 °C · max 23–26 °C	0 km (to be confirmed locally)	To be confirmed with the lodge	Explore the dunes of the Kalahari.	Kalahari Anib Lodge – DBB

DAY BRIEFING

Today there is no road to drive. The plan is to devote the day to free trails by the lodge, making the most of the dunes in the best light, without adding a drive that would add little to the day.

DAY PLAN

07:00–08:00	**Dawn** Watch the first light near the lodge and have breakfast
08:15–11:15	**Active morning** Choose one of the self-guided trails
11:30–14:30	**Midday hours** Self-catering lunch, rest and free time
15:30–18:00	**Late afternoon** Free short walk, rest or confirmed extra option
dinner	**Lodge** Included



DAY 3

Base plan · Self-guided trail

26 July — A day among the Kalahari dunes

BASE PLAN · SELF-GUIDED TRAIL

The lodge lists three free self-guided trails: times depend on sandy ground, photo stops and of the group's pace. Confirm map and local markings before leaving.

LUNCH AND REST

Self-catering lunch at the lodge, followed by rest during the midday hours. There is no logistical need for drive.

LATE AFTERNOON: REAL OPTIONS

Driving your own 4x4s inside Gondwana Kalahari Park is not allowed. Hardap Game Park accepts visitors daytime self-drive, but the agency notes there is little wildlife.

FAUNA OF THIS TERRITORY



Sociable weaver



Meerkat

ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

Day in the same base. Follow the lodge's instructions or the operator responsible for the activity.

DAY 4

27 July — From the Kalahari to the rim of Fish River Canyon

Kalahari Anib Lodge → Garas Quiver Tree Park → Keetmanshoop → Fish River Lodge

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:27 / 18:18	min 3–7 °C · max 22–26 °C	440 km	Recommended 07:00 Max. 07:30	See the Quiver Trees and the sunset of the sun at Fish River Canyon	Fish River Lodge – DBB

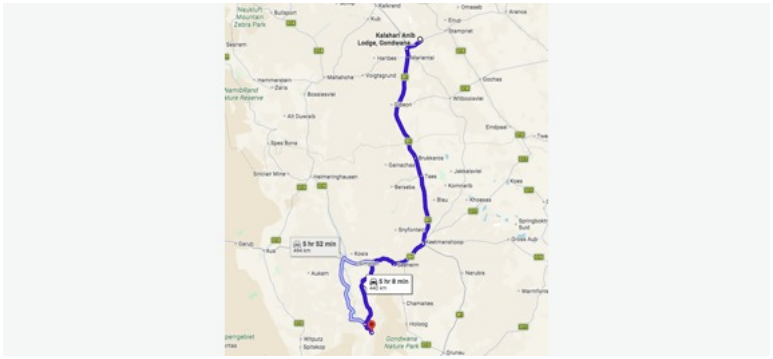
DAY BRIEFING

Today we cross the great south of Namibia on one of the longest days of the trip. Mid-morning we stop at Garas to see the Quiver Trees (kokerboom) among the rock formations. Keetmanshoop is the last full and reliable urban centre before Fish River Lodge — the place to fill up the 4x4s, buy provisions and sort out all the logistics; after that the road becomes remote until the final reward: arriving in daylight at the western rim of Fish River Canyon.

DAY PLAN

07:00	**Kalahari Anib** Leave at first light; early breakfast or packed breakfast if needed
07:00–10:15	**C20 B1 south** Drive via Mariental, Gibeon and Tses
10:15–10:45	**Garas Quiver Tree Park** Main quiver tree stop, right next to the B1
11:00–12:00	**Keetmanshoop** Fuel, restrooms and full shop at SPAR Nuwe Welkom
12:00–13:00	**Picnic** Self-catering lunch; Quiver Tree Forest only if the detour is chosen
13:00–14:00	**Keetmanshoop → B4** Head towards Lüderitz
around 14:00	**D463** Turn south; do not follow C12/Hobas
14:00–17:00	**D463 + final access** Slow driving, gates and very brief photo stops
16:30–17:30	**Fish River Lodge** Arrival and first view of the canyon
late afternoon	**Lodge** Short Guided Canyon Rim Walk only if reception confirms a comfortable window after arrival





DAY 4

Garas, Keetmanshoop and access to Fish River Canyon

27 July — From the Kalahari to the rim of Fish River Canyon

KALAHARI ANIB → MARIENTAL → GARAS

Return via the C20 to the B1 and head south. Mariental is the first town with services and can solve a unexpected need, but it is not a planned stop. Gibeon and Tses should not be used as a base for fuel or provisions. Go first to Garas and then concentrate the strategic stop in Keetmanshoop.

GARAS QUIVER TREE PARK: MAIN STOP

Garas lies right on the B1, about 20 km before Keetmanshoop. It is the main stop of the day because allows you to see a concentration of quiver trees among rock formations without compromising arrival at the canyon. The quiver trees are not trees, but aloes that can live for several centuries.

KEETMANSHOOP: FUEL, TOILETS AND SHOPPING

Keetmanshoop is the last full and reliable centre before Fish River Lodge. Fill up both 4x4s completely and here all the necessary shopping. Buy supplies for: 3 self-catering lunches: 28, 29 and 30 July; 2 dinners self-catering: 29 and 30 July; water and snacks until Lüderitz.

B4 → D463 → FISH RIVER LODGE

After Keetmanshoop, follow the B4 for about 72 km towards Lüderitz and turn south onto the D463. Continue approximately 85 km and slowly do the last 19 km to the lodge. Leave all gates exactly as were found and reduce speed on the final access.

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Buy 3 lunches (28–30 Jul) + 2 dinners (29–30 Jul), at the Keetmanshoop SPAR.
Diesel	Fill up at Keetmanshoop — last reliable stop. ~460 km to Aus (day 29).

NATURAL HIGHLIGHT



Quiver tree / kokerboom



Sociable weaver nest

ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

2507-09	**Kalahari Anib Lodge**	-24.430000, 18.100833
2707-04	**Garas Rest Camp / Garas Quiver Tree Park**	-26.418702, 18.190473
2707-03	**SPAR Nuwe Welkom Keetmanshoop**	-26.576780, 18.135195
2707-06	**B4/D463 junction — used in both directions**	-26.783986, 17.560854
2707-07	**Fish River Lodge Namibia**	-27.527328, 17.536888

DAY 5

28 July — Descending into Fish River Canyon

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:34 / 18:19	min 2–6 °C · max 20–25 °C	0 km (to be confirmed locally)	To be confirmed with the lodge	Walk at Fish River	Fish River Lodge – DBB

DAY BRIEFING

Today is devoted to Fish River Canyon, not just viewing it from the rim but entering its scale. The Canyon Hike is the main experience; the Rim Walk stays optional and should only be chosen locally if the group still has energy.

DAY PLAN

Before 07:00	Early breakfast and preparation; the guide reconfirms departure at the previous evening's dinner
07:00–11:00/12:00	Half-day guided Canyon Hike
Return	Self-catering lunch, hydration and rest
Late afternoon	Short Guided Canyon Rim Walk only if it was not done on day 27 and the group still has energy
Sunset	Return to the lodge and watch the change of light in the canyon





DAY 5

Canyon Hike: what to expect

28 July — Descending into Fish River Canyon

CANYON HIKE: WHAT TO EXPECT

The confirmed Half-Day Canyon Hike takes participants from the viewpoint down into the canyon, to a second viewpoint, and return by the same access. It normally takes 4–5 hours. The terrain is uneven, rocky and exposed; the descent requires attention and the final climb will be the physically most demanding part.

SHORT GUIDED CANYON RIM WALK

The Rim Walk follows marked trails along the canyon edge and normally takes 1–2 hours when accompanied by a guide. It is less demanding than the descent into the canyon and adds context on geology, flora, birds and life wild. The first and last hours of the day offer the best light.

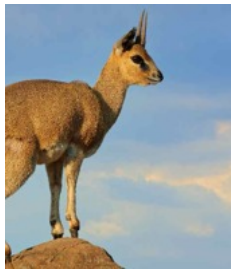
HOW TO READ FISH RIVER CANYON

Fish River Canyon is about 161 km long, reaches roughly 27 km wide and reaches depths close to 550 metres. The winding shape results from a very long geological history.

OPTIONAL ALTERNATIVES

The walk is the highlight of the day. If the Canyon Hike does not go ahead, locally available alternatives can be considered, as alternatives and never as add-ons on the same day: the Short Guided Canyon Rim Walk, the Canyon Drive or the Sundowner Drive.

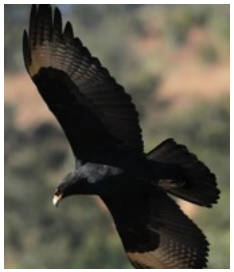
FAUNA OF THIS TERRITORY



Rock hyrax / Klipspringer



Dassie / Rock hyrax



Verreaux's eagle / Verreaux's eagle

ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

Day in the same base. Follow the lodge's instructions or the operator responsible for the activity.

DAY 6

29 July — From Fish River Canyon to the Aus mountains

Fish River Lodge → Goageb → Aus → Desert Horse Inn

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:33 / 18:26	min 4–8 °C · max 19–23 °C	225–230 km	Recommended 09:00 Max. 10:00	Journey to Aus and sunset sun on the Aus mountains.	Desert Horse Inn – BB

DAY BRIEFING

Today we leave the canyon and head west, crossing a region with almost no services to the Aus mountains. The road is relatively short, but the first hours on the D463 are slow. Goageb will be the photo and picnic stop; the aim is to reach the Desert Horse Inn with time to do the Vista Trail at sunset.

DAY PLAN

first light	**Fish River Lodge** Last view of the canyon
07:30–09:00	**Lodge** Breakfast and possibly the Short Guided Canyon Rim Walk, if scheduled this morning
09:00	**Departure** Use the toilet before leaving and begin the slow access to the D463
09:00–11:30	**D463 → B4** Slow drive to the main road
12:00–12:45	**Goageb** Photo stop and self-catering lunch
12:45–15:30	**B4 west** Drive to Aus and Desert Horse Inn
15:00–16:00	**Desert Horse Inn** Arrival and break
around 16:00	**Vista Trail** Start the walk with enough margin to return in daylight
after return	**Dinner** Self-catering





DAY 6

Goageb and the road to Aus

29 July — From Fish River Canyon to the Aus mountains

LEAVING FISH RIVER LODGE

The first kilometres are the slowest part of the day. Do the final access and the D463 without hurry, leaving the gates exactly as they were found. On reaching the B4, turn west towards Aus and Lüderitz.

FISH RIVER LODGE → GOAGEB

The B4 crosses an increasingly empty landscape, partly following the old railway line. Do not
there are functioning villages with services along this stretch. Goageb is a former railway stop, not a town with tourist infrastructure.

GOAGEB → AUS → DESERT HORSE INN

Continue on the B4 to Aus. The landscape gradually changes from open plains to the rocky hills of the Aus Mountains. The operational priority is to reach Aus in time for the best light at the end of the day, reserving it for the Vista Trail and sunset viewpoints.

GOAGEB: PHOTOGRAPHY, PICNIC AND LIMITS

Goageb is the day's lunch waypoint because it coincides with a photo stop and requires no detour. Use the toilet at the Fish River Lodge, right before departure. The next reliable toilet will be in Aus or at the Desert Horse Inn.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

2707-07	**Fish River Lodge Namibia**	-27.527328, 17.536888
2707-06	**B4/D463 junction — used in both directions**	-26.783986, 17.560854
2907-03	**Goageb Railway Station**	-26.750400, 17.224800
2907-05	**Desert Horse Inn Klein-Aus Vista**	-26.652114, 16.244645

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Meals already secured (Keetmanshoop provisions).
Diesel	No fuelling today; Namib Garage (Aus) only as a contingency. Fill up on the morning of 30 July.

DAY 7

30 July — Diamonds, ocean and the Namib horses

Desert Horse Inn → Kolmanskop → Lüderitz → Garub → Desert Horse Inn

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:36 / 18:27	min 8–14 °C · max 19–22 °C	245 km	Recommended 07:30–07:45 Max. 08:00	Visit Kolmanskop.	Desert Horse Inn – BB

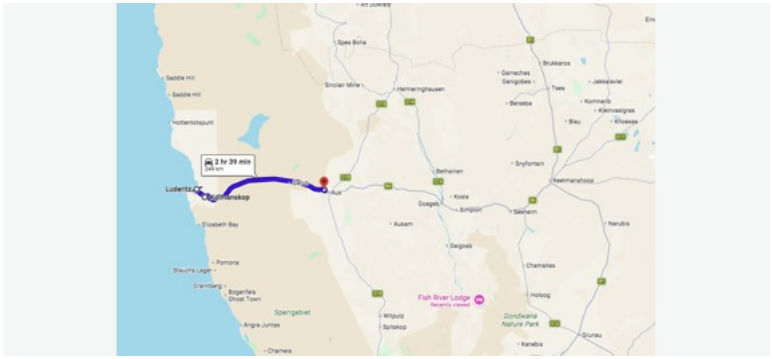
DAY BRIEFING

Today we cross the border between the desert and the Atlantic. Kolmanskop is the main visit; Lüderitz adds architecture, coast and a difficult colonial history. On the way back, Garub offers the chance to see the Namib's feral horses before returning to Aus.

DAY PLAN

07:00–07:30	**Desert Horse Inn** Breakfast included
07:30–07:45	**Aus** Use the toilet and, if needed, fill up at Namib Garage
07:45–09:15	**B4 west** Drive towards Kolmanskop
09:15–12:00	**Kolmanskop** Self-guided exploration and guided visit at 11:00
12:15–13:15	**Lüderitz** Self-catering lunch or optional restaurant
13:15–14:00	**SPAR Lüderitz** Full shopping
14:00–15:15	**Lüderitz** Historic centre, Felsenkirche and Shark Island
until 15:30	**Decision** Return directly, or do Diaz Point only with ample margin
return	**Garub** Stop at the feral horse hide
before 18:27	**Desert Horse Inn** Arrival and self-catering dinner





DAY 7

Kolmanskop and Lüderitz

30 July — Diamonds, ocean and the Namib horses

DESERT HORSE INN → NAMIB GARAGE → KOLMANSKOP

Back a few kilometres to Aus and fill up completely before heading to the coast. The B4 crosses open plains and exposed to wind; reduce speed in strong gusts, sand on the road or animals. Kolmanskop is before Lüderitz and should be visited directly, without first entering the town.

KOLMANSKOP: THE DAY'S PRIORITY

Kolmanskop was born after diamonds were discovered in 1908. Within a few years, the desert received a hospital, school, casino, ballroom, ice factory and sophisticated houses. When diamond mining moved south, the settlement was abandoned and the dunes began to occupy the buildings.

LÜDERITZ: LUNCH, SHOPPING AND HISTORIC CENTRE

Lüderitz sits isolated between the Atlantic and the Sperrgebiet. The centre preserves buildings of German influence, with towers, gables, balconies and Art Nouveau elements. During lunch and shopping, observe the Bahnhof, Berg, Bismarck and Ring. Felsenkirche dominates Diamond Hill and offers a good viewpoint over the city and the bay.

RETURN VIA THE B4 AND GARUB

At the end of the day, as an optional stop, visit the hide at Garub waterhole to see the wild horses of the Namib (Aus feral horses). Horses are not guaranteed; you may need to wait. Stay at the hide, do not feed the animals and do not try to approach them.

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Extended shopping at SPAR Lüderitz: 4 lunches (31 Jul–3 Aug) + emergency breakfast.
Diesel	Fill up at Namib Garage (Aus) at the start of the day; Lüderitz also has a pump (~125 km).

FAUNA OF THIS TERRITORY



Namib desert horses



African penguin

ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

2907-04	**Namib Garage Aus**	-26.666420, 16.260890
3007-02	**Kolmanskop Ghost Town**	-26.701727, 15.231932
3007-04	**Felsenkirche Lüderitz**	-26.649782, 15.152184
3007-03	**SPAR Lüderitz**	-26.646139, 15.154103
2907-05	**Desert Horse Inn Klein-Aus Vista**	-26.652114, 16.244645

DAY 8

31 July — Remote roads and a castle in the desert

Desert Horse Inn → Helmeringhausen → Betta → Duwisib Castle → BüllsPort Lodge

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:36 / 18:31	min 3–8 °C · max 20–25 °C	410 km	Recommended 07:15–07:30 Max. 07:30	Scenic drive to Naukluft.	BüllsPort Lodge & Farm – DBB

DAY BRIEFING

Today we leave the Aus plains and cross some of the most remote roads of southern Namibia to the Naukluft mountains. Duwisib Castle is the cultural visit main; Helmeringhausen and Betta are support stops on a day when the route itself is part of the experience.

DAY PLAN

06:30–07:15	**Desert Horse Inn** Breakfast included
07:15–07:30	**Departure** Confirm full tank, water and lunch in the 4x4s
09:30–10:00	**Helmeringhausen** Toilets, coffee and short break
11:30–12:15	**Betta Camp** Toilets, safety refuel and picnic lunch
12:30–13:30	**Duwisib Castle** Main cultural visit
13:30–17:00	**D826 → D845 → C19 → D854 → C14** Continue to BüllsPort with brief photo stops
16:30–17:15	**BüllsPort Lodge** Arrival, rest and included dinner





DAY 8

Helmeringhausen, Betta and Duwisib

31 July — Remote roads and a castle in the desert

AUS → HELMERINGHAUSEN

Head north and north-east across large plains, remote farms and isolated hills. The start of the day is long and sparsely populated; keep fuel, water and tyre pressure under control. Helmeringhausen is a small private settlement created around a farm.

HELMERINGHAUSEN → BETTA CAMP

Continue on the C27, one of southern Namib's scenic roads. The landscape alternates open plains and hills dry and very distant farms.

BETTA → DUWISIB CASTLE

Duwisib was built in 1908–1909 for the German officer Hans Heinrich von Wolf and his wife, Jayta Humphreys. The red sandstone building, designed by Wilhelm Sander, seems out of place in the rural landscape and helps understand the scale and contradictions of German colonial presence.

DUWISIB → BÜLLSPORT

The last stretch continues on gravel roads until it meets the C14. As the Naukluft approaches, the landscape becomes more mountainous. BüllsPort is a former cattle and horse farm next to the massif of Naukluft. Today is only the destination for the day; the walks are for the next morning.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

2907-05	**Desert Horse Inn Klein-Aus Vista**	-26.652114, 16.244645
3107-02	**Helmeringhausen Hotel**	-25.889130, 16.821399
3107-03	**Betta Camp Namibia**	-25.382440, 16.424318
3107-04	**Duwisib Castle**	-25.257071, 16.541282
0108S-01	**BüllsPort Lodge & Farm**	-24.146745, 16.359911

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Meals already secured (Lüderitz purchase); picnic lunch at Betta.
Diesel	Leave Aus with a full tank — ~410 km to BüllsPort. Betta (~230 km) is a safety refuel.

DAY 9

1 August — Walking and exploring BüllsPort

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:31 / 18:31	min 4–8 °C · max 21–25 °C	0 km (to be confirmed locally)	To be confirmed with the lodge	Mountain walk Naukluft and relaxation.	BüllsPort Lodge & Farm – DBB

DAY BRIEFING

Today we explore the Naukluft landscape without changing accommodation. The morning is reserved for one of the well-marked walks on the property; afterwards after lunch we can rest or, if booked, do a guided lodge activity.

DAY PLAN

06:30–07:15	**BüllsPort** Breakfast included
07:30–10:30	**Walk** Short Archaeological Trail as base plan
10:30–12:30	**Lodge** Return, rest and free time
12:30–13:30	**Lunch** Self-catering picnic
14:30–17:30	**Flexible afternoon** Rest, short walk or activity booked with the lodge
dinner	**BüllsPort** Included



DAY 9

Base walk: Short Archaeological Trail

1 August — Walking and exploring BüllsPort

BASE WALK: SHORT ARCHAEOLOGICAL TRAIL

The Archaeological Trail combines landscape, farm history and traces of human occupation. The short version can be completed independently in about 2.5 hours, following the markings and the map provided by the lodge.

OPTIONAL

Those who want to go beyond the base walk have two main options, both organised by the lodge: The activities with vehicle or guide must be booked in advance, especially in high season. The longest walks of the Naukluft do not combine well with a 4x4 excursion on the same day.

FUEL

No need to refuel on the base plan.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0108S-01	**BüllsPort Lodge & Farm** -24.146745, 16.359911

DAY 10

2 August — First encounter with Sossusvlei

BüllsPort Lodge → Sesriem Canyon → Deadvlei → Sossusvlei → Sossus Dune Lodge

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:30 / 18:34	min 5–9 °C · max 25–29 °C	245 km	Recommended 07:45–08:00 Max. 09:00	Visit Deadvlei and Sossusvlei.	Sossus Dune Lodge – DBB

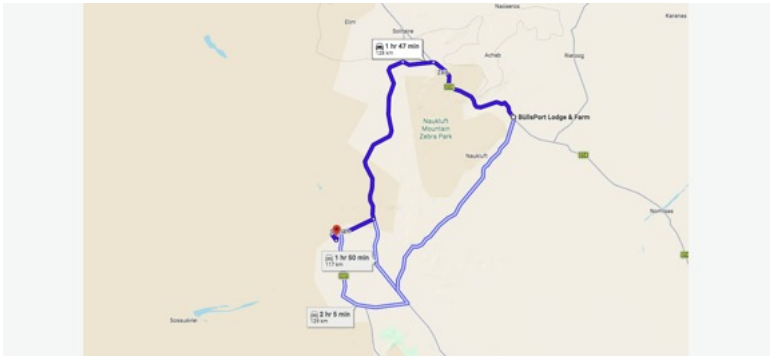
DAY BRIEFING

After a short drive to Sesriem, we visit the canyon and enter the heart of the Namib to devote the afternoon to Big Daddy, Deadvlei and Sossusvlei. Deadvlei and Sossusvlei are the priorities; the full climb of Big Daddy adapts to wind, heat, energy and schedule.

DAY PLAN

06:45–07:30	**BüllsPort** Breakfast included
07:45–08:00	**Departure** Follow the C14, D854 and C19 towards Sesriem
09:30–10:00	**Sossus Oasis / Sesriem** Fuel up, use the restrooms and sort out the permits
10:00–11:00	**Sesriem Canyon** Short walk and geological reading
11:15–12:00	**Sesriem / lodge** Picnic lunch and preparation for the afternoon
12:15–13:30	**Internal road** Head to the 2x4 Parking and final access
13:30–17:45	**Big Daddy / Deadvlei / Sossusvlei** Apply Plan A or Plan B depending on conditions
late afternoon	**Sossus Dune Lodge** Return within internal schedule and dinner included





DAY 10

Sesriem Canyon, Big Daddy and Deadvlei

2 August — First encounter with Sossusvlei

BÜLLSPORT → SESRIEM

Follow the C14 along the Naukluft mountains, turn onto the D854 and then the C19/C27 towards Sesriem. The stretch is short, but mostly on gravel. On arrival, use Sossus Oasis to refuel only if needed, use the toilet and obtain the necessary permits.

SESRIEM CANYON

The Tsauchab River carved Sesriem Canyon over millions of years. The name comes from the six leather straps, *sesriem*, the ropes early travellers joined together to reach the water at the bottom. Allow about 45–60 minutes. The access involves uneven ground and there may be sand or water at the bottom.

SESRIEM → 2X4 PARKING

The sealed road runs about 60 km along the Tsauchab corridor, between progressively taller dunes. Dune Dune 45 will be visited at sunrise the next day; today head straight for the valley floor. The 2x4 parking ends the tarmac.

PLAN A: FULL BIG DADDY (OPTIONAL)

Big Daddy rises about 325 metres between Sossusvlei and Deadvlei. The full climb demands considerable effort in loose sand, followed by a direct descent to Deadvlei.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0208-01	**BüllsPort Lodge & Farm**	-24.148850, 16.362883
0208-03	**Sesriem Canyon**	-24.518486, 15.799772
0208-05	**Sossusvlei 2x4 Parking**	-24.729966, 15.322584
0208-07	**Deadvlei Namibia**	-24.747022, 15.290956
0208-08	**Sossusvlei Namibia**	-24.741259, 15.288165
0208-04	**Sossus Dune Lodge**	-24.506602, 15.788957

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Meals already secured; only water, ice and snacks if needed.
Diesel	Fill up at Sossus Oasis (Sesriem) only if necessary. Next reliable pump: Solitaire (day 3).

DAY 11

3 August — From the dunes to the Atlantic

Sossus Dune Lodge → Dune 45 → Solitaire → Gaub Pass → Kuiseb Pass → Walvis Bay → Swakopmund

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:34 / 18:42	min 7–11 °C · max 18–28 °C	345 km	Recommended 06:30–06:45 Max. 09:00	Sunrise at Dune 45.	Jetty Self-Catering Units – SC

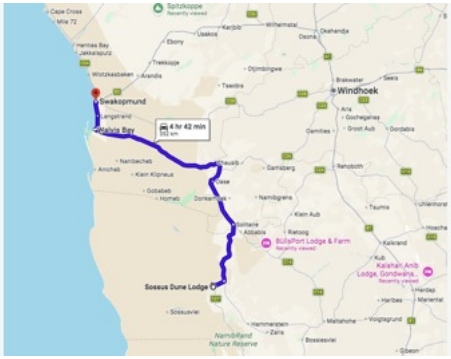
DAY BRIEFING

Today we see first light at Dune 45 and cross the Namib to the Atlantic. The road passes Solitaire, Gaub Pass, the Tropic of Capricorn and Kuiseb Canyon before reach Walvis Bay and Swakopmund. The focus is on enjoying the crossing of the Namib to the coast and reaching Swakopmund with time for the necessary shopping of the self-catering.

DAY PLAN

06:30–06:45	**Sossus Dune Lodge** Leave with packed breakfast, water and warm clothing within reach
07:15–08:30	**Dune 45** Sunrise, photography and climb at the group's pace
08:30–09:00	**Departure from Sesriem** Start the crossing to the coast
10:15–11:15	**Solitaire** Fuel, restrooms and packed breakfast / early picnic lunch
11:15–14:45	**C14** Gaub Pass, Tropic of Capricorn and Kuiseb Pass
15:45–16:15	**Walvis Bay** Pass through the town; the lagoon only if there is a good margin
16:15–17:00	**B2 → Swakopmund** Head to the destination
17:00–18:30	**Swakopmund** Main shopping and fuel, as needed
end of day	**Jetty Self-Catering Units** Check-in and simple self-catering dinner





DAY 11

Dune 45 at sunrise

3 August — From the dunes to the Atlantic

DUNE 45 AT SUNRISE

Dune 45 is named after its position at roughly kilometre 45 of the internal road. The first light creates strong shadows on the ridge and highlights the shape of the dune. The group may climb as far as is comfortable within the window available. A full climb is possible at a steady pace, but it should end in time to start the crossing during the morning.

KUISEB PASS AND CANYON

The Kuiseb River acts as a natural barrier between the great red dunes to the south and the gravel plains to the north. Even though it stays dry for much of the year, its bed limits the advance of the dunes. During World War II, the geologists Henno Martin and Hermann Korn took refuge in this region to avoid hospitalisation.

SESRIEM → SOLITAIRE

After leaving the park, follow the C19 and C14. Solitaire is the main logistics stop of the day: fill up all three 4x4s; use the toilet; eat the packed breakfast or make an early picnic lunch; try the well-known apple crumble, if there is margin; confirm range to the coast.

GAUB PASS

Gaub Pass is a natural pass on the C14 through eroded terrain. It requires no detour: just make a short photo stop at a wide, safe setback. The Moon Landscape and Welwitschia Drive are not points of on this route; they lie on a different road east of Swakopmund.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0208-04	**Sossus Dune Lodge**	-24.506602, 15.788957
0308-02	**Dune 45 Namibia**	-24.723060, 15.470979
0308-03	**Solitaire Namibia**	-23.893443, 16.005829
0308-04	**Gaub Pass C14 Namibia**	-23.482690, 15.760938
0308-06	**Kuiseb Canyon Namibia**	-23.341717, 15.744623
0308-11	**Jetty Self Catering Units**	-22.681711, 14.522839

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Main shopping in Swakopmund (until Outjo): 4 breakfasts · 5 lunches · 4 dinners. Minimum today: 2 dinners + 2 breakfasts + 1 lunch.
Diesel	Fill up in Solitaire without fail — ~230 km to the coast (Walvis Bay/Swakopmund).

DAY 12

4 August — Dunes, ocean and seals in Walvis Bay

Swakopmund, Walvis Bay, Sandwich Harbour 4x4 / kayaking, free afternoon in Swakopmund

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:34 / 18:42	min 10–13 °C · max 18–22 °C	70 km	Recommended 07:45	Coastal experiences: dunes, ocean and seals.	Jetty Self-Catering Units – SC

DAY BRIEFING

This morning the group splits into two complementary coastal experiences: four participants go by 4x4 to Sandwich Harbour and five go kayaking alongside of Pelican Point. After the reunion in Walvis Bay, the afternoon is free for rest, a walk or shopping in Swakopmund.

DAY PLAN

Before departure	**Two groups** Self-catering breakfast and independent preparation.
07:45	**Kayaking group** Be present at the point indicated by the operator.
08:15	**Sandwich Harbour group** Attend the Booking and Check-in Office in Walvis Bay.
around 13:00	**Reunion** Return from both activities; neither includes lunch.
Afternoon	**Swakopmund** Late lunch, rest and completing shopping for the following days.
End of day	**Jetty Self-Catering** Self-catering dinner.





DAY 12

Relaxed afternoon in Swakopmund

4 August — Sandwich Harbour, kayaking and free afternoon

RELAXED AFTERNOON IN SWAKOPMUND

If on day 3 only the minimum shopping was done, this is the preferred window to buy the remainder until Outjo: 2 breakfasts, 4 picnic lunches and 2 self-catering dinners.

SANDWICH HARBOUR

Sandwich Harbour is a sheltered coastal lagoon south of Walvis Bay. Its most striking scene appears when the high dunes end directly in the Atlantic, sometimes leaving only a narrow passable strip of sand between the water and the slope. The route depends on the tide, swell, wind and sand conditions.

KAYAKING AT PELICAN POINT

Pelican Point is a long sand peninsula that shelters the bay of Walvis Bay. Its main attraction is the colony of Cape fur seals, often accompanied by pelicans and other seabirds. Dolphins can be seen during marine activities, but never guaranteed.

BOTANICAL ALTERNATIVE · WELWITSCHIA DRIVE

East of Swakopmund, the Welwitschia Drive crosses the Moon Landscape and ends at the Welwitschia Plains, one of the largest concentrations of Welwitschia mirabilis. This is the circuit's real opportunity to see the plant in its habitat natural. The welwitschia is an endemic gymnosperm of the Namib desert, restricted to an arid strip of Angola and Namibia.

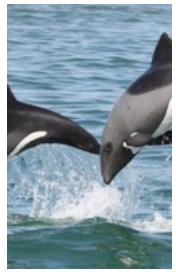
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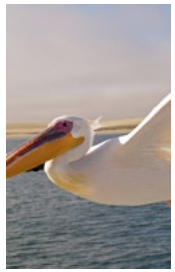
Cape fur seal



Greater flamingo



Heaviside's dolphin



Great white pelican

ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0308-11	**Jetty Self Catering Units**	-22.681711, 14.522839
0408-02	**Sandwich Harbour 4x4 — Booking and Check-in Office**	-22.958098, 14.482817
0408-05	**Swakopmund Jetty**	-22.680690, 14.521910
0408-06	**Checkers Platz Am Meer Swakopmund**	-22.645694, 14.527348

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Complete the shopping in Swakopmund if on day 3 you only bought the minimum: 2 breakfasts, 4 lunches and 2 dinners are still missing.
Diesel	No mandatory refuelling; Walvis Bay and Swakopmund have pumps if needed.

DAY 13

5 August — Small desert residents and arrival at Spitzkoppe

Swakopmund Living Desert Tour, shopping and fuel, Spitzkoppe Cabin Camp

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:34 / 18:41	min 10–13 °C · max 18–22 °C	≈160 km	Recommended 13:30–13:45 Max. 14:00	Meet the little ones desert inhabitants and reach Spitzkoppe at late afternoon.	Spitzkoppe Cabin Camp – SC

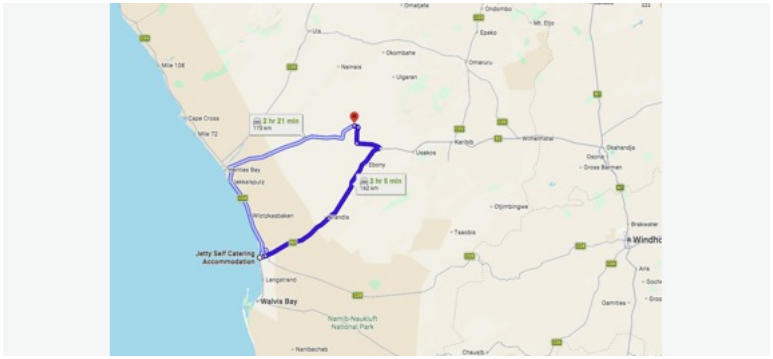
DAY BRIEFING

The morning reveals the Namib at the scale of its tiny inhabitants on the Living Desert Tour. After returning, you must restock provisions and fuel before leave Swakopmund; the afternoon priority is to reach Spitzkoppe with enough light to enjoy the first approach to the great granite domes. Watch the block tight 13:00–14:30 window: on returning from the Living Desert you must refuel, do the extended shopping in Swakopmund and set off for Spitzkoppe in time for the light — split the supermarket list for the 4x4s to get in and out quickly.

DAY PLAN

06:45–07:30	**Jetty Self-Catering Units** Self-catering breakfast and luggage preparation
07:50 / 08:00–approx. from 13:00	**Living Desert Tour** Be ready at 07:50; pick-up at 08:00 and return to the Jetty Self-Catering Units; your own 4x4s stay parked
12:00/13:00–14:00	**Swakopmund** Additional shopping, fuel, restrooms and quick picnic lunch
until 14:00	**Recommended departure** Follow the direct route to Spitzkoppe
16:15–16:45	**First approach to Spitzkoppe** Short photo stop in a safe spot
16:30–17:00	**Spitzkoppe Cabin Camp** Arrival, settling in and orientation
late afternoon	**Spitzkoppe** First views and sunset without a demanding walk
night	**Cabin Camp** Self-catering dinner and stargazing





DAY 13

Living Desert Tour

5 August — Small desert residents and arrival at Spitzkoppe

LIVING DESERT TOUR

The Living Desert Tour aims to reveal the life hidden in the coastal dunes. Instead of a safari of large animals, the guide reads tracks, movements in the sand and adaptations to the arid environment. The group should be ready at the Jetty Self-Catering Units by 07:50 for the pick-up at 08:00.

MANDATORY LOGISTICS STOP IN SWAKOPMUND

After the tour, allow at most about an hour for a quick lunch, shopping and fuel. The time available will depend on the actual return time.

PROVISIONS CHECK

Suitable supermarkets: Swakopmund SUPERSPAR: main option for a full shop; Checkers Platz Am Meer: large chain and full-service option; Woermann Brock Swakopmund: useful local alternative, especially for quick top-ups. After Swakopmund, do not rely on shopping in Spitzkoppe.

FIRST VIEW OF SPITZKOPPE · PRIORITY

Spitzkoppe gradually emerges above a nearly flat plain. Reserve a short photo stop, only at a wide, safe setback, when the granite domes become clearly visible. The formations have approximately 700 million years.

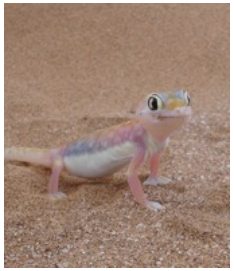
FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Complete the extended shopping in Swakopmund (until Outjo), if not already done.
Diesel	Fill up the 4x4s in Swakopmund before leaving — ~290 km to Uis (day 7), next reliable pump.

FAUNA OF THIS TERRITORY



Fog-basking beetle / Fog-basking beetle



Web-footed gecko / Web-footed gecko



Peringuey's adder / Peringuey's adder

ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0308-11	**Jetty Self Catering Units**	-22.681711, 14.522839
0508-04	**Convenient fuel station before the B2**	-22.669616, 14.546534
0508-06	**B2, D1918 to Spitzkoppe**	-21.979561, 15.359956
0508-06B	**D1918 D3716 to Spitzkoppe**	-21.945693, 15.196033
0508-07	**Spitzkoppe viewpoint — proposed safe stop**	-21.892176, 15.197428
0508-08	**Spitzkoppe Cabin Camp**	-21.851468, 15.194985

DAY 14

6 August — Rock art and granite at Spitzkoppe

Spitzkoppe Cabin Camp guided rock art, Natural Arch, formations and sunset viewpoint

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:29 / 18:41	min 7–11 °C · max 25–29 °C	0 km (to be confirmed locally)	To be confirmed with the lodge	Guided rock art visit rock art and night sky.	Spitzkoppe Cabin Camp – SC

DAY BRIEFING

Today there is no road to follow. The day belongs to Spitzkoppe: we start with its human and spiritual dimension on a guided rock art visit, then explore the granite formations calmly, and we end with the sunset light and one of the best night skies of the trip.

DAY PLAN

07:00–08:00	**Cabin Camp**	Sunrise near the base and self-catering breakfast
08:30–11:30	**Rock art**	Guided tour on the locally recommended route
11:30–13:00	**Granite formations**	Natural Arch and nearby stops
13:00–14:00	**Licensed local**	Picnic lunch
14:00–16:00	**Cabin Camp**	Rest during the hottest hours
16:00–18:30	**Spitzkoppe**	Short walk, viewpoint and sunset
night	**Cabin Camp**	Self-catering dinner and stargazing



DAY 14

Rock art · main experience

6 August — Rock art and granite at Spitzkoppe

ROCK ART · MAIN EXPERIENCE

Spitzkoppe preserves dozens of rock art sites and archaeological traces associated with occupation hunter-gatherer. The paintings are not just old images: they record knowledge of the territory, animals, experiences and spiritual relationships. Vulnerable areas should be visited with a guide.

NATURAL ARCH · PRIORITY

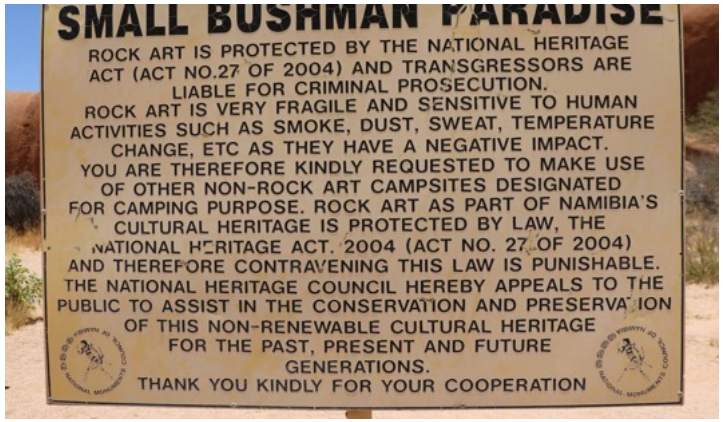
The Natural Arch is one of Spitzkoppe's most recognisable formations. The arch results from differential erosion of the granite and creates a natural frame for the peaks and the plain. Set aside time for photography and a short walk, respecting the indicated access routes.

ROCK POOLS

Natural depressions in the granite can hold water after rain; in August they may be dry. Confirm locally if they are of interest before driving.

PONTOK AND LATE-AFTERNOON VIEWPOINT

The Pontok Mountains and other formations allow choosing a short walk for the end of the day. The priority is find a good viewpoint, not complete a long trail. Choose the route according to the group's condition and return before dark. Granite surfaces can be sloped and slippery, especially with sand loose.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0508-08	**Spitzkoppe Cabin Camp**	-21.851468, 15.194985
0608-03	**Spitzkoppe Natural Arch**	-21.846392, 15.183376

DAY 15

7 August — From Spitzkoppe to the heart of Damaraland

Spitzkoppe → Uis → Brandberg / Dâures → Fransfontein → Huab Lodge

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:29 / 18:46	min 7–12 °C · max 26–31 °C	290 km	Recommended 08:00 Max. 09:00	Scenic drive through the Damaraland scenery.	Huab Lodge – DBB

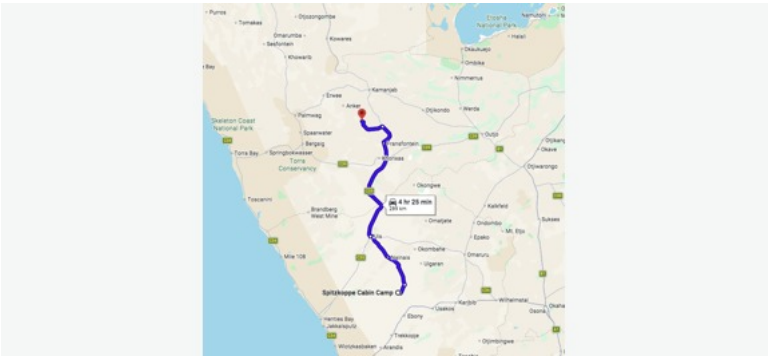
DAY BRIEFING

We leave the Spitzkoppe domes and enter Damaraland by a mining route, sacred mountains and rural villages. Uis is the mandatory logistics stop; the Brandberg is the day's great scenic and cultural highlight, with no need to turn the trip into a demanding hike to the White Lady.

DAY PLAN

06:45–07:30	**Spitzkoppe Cabin Camp** Self-catering breakfast and picnic preparation
08:00	**Departure** Follow the D3716, D1930 and C36 towards Uis
09:45–10:30	**Uis** Fuel, restrooms, basics and optional Daureb Crafts
10:30–13:30	**Brandberg / Dâures corridor** Views from the C35 area, cultural context and picnic
13:30–17:00	**C35 / C39 → Fransfontein → D2670** Head to Huab with brief stops
17:00–17:45	**Huab Lodge** Arrival in daylight and orientation
night	**Huab Lodge** Dinner included





DAY 15

Brandberg / Dâures and the road to Huab

7 August — From Spitzkoppe to the heart of Damaraland

UIS · MANDATORY STOP

Uis developed around tin and tungsten mining. The large pale spoil heaps continue to define the landscape; mining activity has regained importance with minerals such as lithium and tantalum.

BRANDBERG / DÂURES

The Brandberg is Namibia's highest mountain. Its summit, Königstein, reaches about 2,573 metres. The name Brandberg means "mountain of fire", linked to the reddish glow it can take on; in Damara, Dâures also means "burning mountain".

BASE PLAN · VIEWS, CONTEXT AND PICNIC

The base objective is to view the mountain from the C35 area, stop at a safe spot for photos and do the picnic overlooking the massif. This choice lets you understand the landscape without adding a long walk or a significant detour to the driving day.

FULL WHITE LADY · CONDITIONAL OPTION

The walk to the White Lady is guided and takes roughly 2.5–3 hours, about 5 km return over terrain uneven and exposed.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0508-08	**Spitzkoppe Cabin Camp**	-21.851468, 15.194985
0708-02	**Fuel Station Uis Namibia**	-21.219235, 14.869303
0708-05	**White Lady Heritage Centre Namibia**	-21.093463, 14.675902
0708-06	**Fransfontein Namibia**	-20.210872, 15.017736
0708-07	**C35 D2670 to Huab Lodge**	-20.028019, 14.998836
0708-08	**Huab Lodge Namibia**	-19.972265, 14.761268

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Only basic restocking in Uis (water, bread, ice, snacks). Next full shop: Outjo (day 9).
Diesel	Fill up in Uis without fail — ~450 km to Outjo (day 9), with no reliable pump in between.

DAY 16

8 August — Living Damaraland

Huab Lodge balanced plan at the lodge / Damaraland culture / Ephemeral River Drive

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:28 / 18:47	min 8–13 °C · max 27–32 °C	0 km (to be confirmed locally)	To be confirmed with the lodge	Explore Damaraland.	Huab Lodge – DBB

DAY BRIEFING

Today there is no single right answer. The recommendation is to stay in the Huab area, combining walking, rock art, hot springs and free time; those who prefer may instead swap that pace for a cultural day in Twyfelfontein and the Damara Living Museum, or for a guided expedition to the ephemeral rivers in search of the elephants of the desert. It is worth exploring with Huab Lodge the possibility of a visit to a village with a local guide.

DAY PLAN

before or after the breakfast	**Guided walk** Route recommended by the lodge, making the most of the cool hours
morning	**Rock art** Interpretive visit in the Huab area
12:30–14:00	**Lodge** Picnic lunch and rest
14:00–16:00	**German Bath / pool** Natural hot springs and free time
late afternoon	**Local choice** Scenic drive, sundowner drive or continued rest
night	**Lodge** Dinner included, German Bath or stargazing





DAY 16

Various options to enjoy Damaraland

8 August — Three ways to experience Damaraland

OPTION A — BALANCED

This is the most suitable option after the previous drives and before entering Etosha. It lets you enjoy the resort and the private reserve, with short interpretive walks, rock art and free time, adapting the effort to the group. It is worth trying a cultural visit to a village with a local guide and, possibly, a visit to a San community.

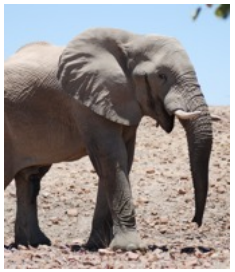
OPTION B — EPHEMERAL RIVER DRIVE

The Ephemeral River Drive is a full-day guided expedition in the lodge's vehicle.

OPTION C — CULTURAL DAMARALAND

This is the option with the richest cultural and archaeological content, but it means a long self-drive day. It combines two very different experiences: Damara Living Museum. The museum is a structured community initiative that presents traditional Damara practices predating colonisation.

FAUNA OF THIS TERRITORY



Elephant adapted to the desert / Desert elephant



Giraffe



Greater kudu

ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0708-08 **Huab Lodge Namibia**
-19.972265, 14.761268

DAY 17

9 August — Ugab Terraces and first entry into Etosha

Huab Lodge → Ugab Terraces / Vingerklip → Outjo → Andersson Gate → Okaukuejo

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:27 / 18:43	min 8–13 °C · max 27–32 °C	320 km	Recommended 07:00–07:30 Max. 07:30	Enjoy the landscapes of the Ugab river valley and reach Etosha.	Okaukuejo Rest Camp – BB

DAY BRIEFING

Today we leave Damaraland, cross the sculpted landscapes of the Ugab valley and enter Etosha. Vingerklip is the big scenic stop, but the priority priority is to arrive early in Outjo to shop and refuel before continuing to Okaukuejo, with the first animal sightings in Etosha and the first evening at the lit waterhole.

DAY PLAN

06:30–07:15	**Huab Lodge** Breakfast included and departure
09:00–10:30	**Ugab Terraces / Vingerklip** Landscape and short walk depending on time
12:00–13:30	**Outjo** Full shopping, fuel and restrooms
13:30–14:00	**Outjo / safe stop** Prepare and eat a picnic lunch
14:00–14:30	**Departure from Outjo** Follow the C38 towards Etosha
15:30–16:00	**Etosha Trading Post / Andersson Gate** Optional top-up and park entry
16:30–17:30	**Etosha → Okaukuejo** First short safari according to available time
end of day	**Okaukuejo** Self-catering dinner and lit waterhole





DAY 17

Ugab valley, Vingerklip and entry into Etosha

9 August — Ugab Terraces and first entry into Etosha

FULL SHOP

In Outjo, buy supplies for 4 picnic lunches: 9–12 August, and 2 self-catering dinners: 9–10 August. The remaining breakfasts and dinners of this stage are included in the accommodation. Buy: 4 picnic lunches: 9, 10, 11 and 12 August; 2 self-catering dinners: 9 and 10 August; water, ice, snacks, fruit, drinks and consumables for Etosha.

OUTJO · TOP PRIORITY

Outjo is the last town with full supermarkets before entering Etosha. As 9 August 2026 is Sunday: do shopping and fuel first; lunch and other breaks come later.

ENTRY TO ETOSHA

Follow the C38 to Andersson Gate. Etosha occupies a vast salt depression, the pan, surrounded by savannah and waterholes that concentrate fauna during the dry season.

OKAUKUEJO AND THE LIT WATERHOLE

Okaukuejo is known for its lit waterhole, reachable on foot from the camp. During the dry season, it can attract elephants, rhinos, giraffes and antelopes, especially late in the day and at night. After dinner, return to the waterhole and observe patiently.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0708-08	**Huab Lodge Namibia**	-19.972265, 14.761268
0908-02	**Ugab Terrace Nature Reserve — to verify access / viewpoint**	-20.320221, 15.444593
0908-03	**Vingerklip Namibia**	-20.382995, 15.434016
0908-04	**SPAR Outjo Namibia**	-20.106237, 16.151540
0908-08	**Andersson Gate Etosha National Park**	-19.331450, 15.940180
0908-09	**Okaukuejo Rest Camp Namibia**	-19.179126, 15.919134

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Full shopping in Outjo: 4 lunches (9–12 Aug) + 2 dinners (9–10 Aug) + consumables for Etosha.
Diesel	Fill up in Outjo without fail; top up at the Etosha camps when available.

DAY 18

10 August — Etosha safari from Okaukuejo

Okaukuejo waterholes of the western/central region, Okaukuejo

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:20 / 18:43	min 7–12 °C · max 27–31 °C	Variable, depending on the circuit	When the camp opens	Safari in Etosha	Okaukuejo Rest Camp – BB

DAY BRIEFING

The best safari is not the one that covers the most kilometres but the one that knows how to wait. Today the plan adapts to sightings and open roads: leave early, observe with patience, return to camp during the hot hours and go back out in the late afternoon.

DAY PLAN

opening of the camp–09:30	**Morning loop** Choose waterholes according to local information and first sightings
09:30–11:30	**Flexible continuation** Stay where there is activity or return slowly
11:30–15:30	**Okaukuejo** Late breakfast/lunch, rest, pool and waterhole
15:30–camp closing	**Short loop** Second departure, without going too far
night	**Okaukuejo waterhole** Stargazing after dinner



DAY 18

How the route is built

10 August — Flexible safari from Okaukuejo

HOW THE ROUTE IS BUILT

Before leaving, check the sightings book or board, ask about available water and confirm open roads or detours.

VIEWING STRATEGY

Switch off the engine when safe and permitted; speak quietly and avoid sudden movements; do not block the passage of other vehicles; keep a distance from animals and never leave the road; watch birds, behaviour and landscape, not only the large mammals; use binoculars before deciding to bring the vehicle closer.

HOT HOURS IN OKAUKUEJO

Returning to camp during the hottest period lets you rest and avoids turning the safari into a marathon. Use this interval for: picnic lunch; pool and rest; watch the camp waterhole; check fuel; reorganise cameras, batteries and water; check new sightings before the afternoon departure.

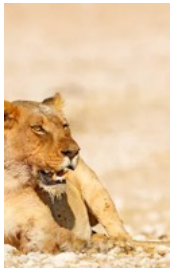
LIT WATERHOLE

The Okaukuejo waterhole remains one of the stay's main experiences. Visit after dinner and return later, if there is activity. Black rhinos are known visitors, but silence and patience are more important than any specific expectation.

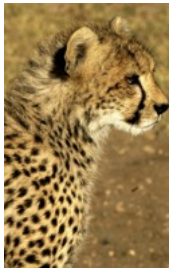
FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Only basic top-ups at the camp. Next full shop: Tsumeb (day 12).
Diesel	Confirm fuel in Okaukuejo before the circuit; maintain range.

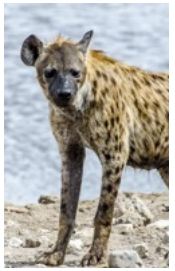
FAUNA OF THIS TERRITORY



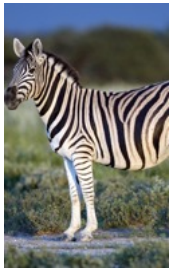
Lion



Cheetah



Spotted hyena



Plains zebra

ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0908-09	**Okaukuejo Rest Camp Namibia**	-19.179126, 15.919134
1008-02	**Nebrownii Waterhole Etosha**	-19.162898, 15.995508
1008-03	**Gemsbokvlakte Waterhole Etosha**	-19.213424, 16.058248
1008-04	**Olifantsbad Waterhole — confirm road is open**	-19.238763, 16.131072
1008-05	**Aus Waterhole Etosha**	-19.205186, 16.192573
1008-06	**Okondeka Waterhole Etosha**	-18.994319, 15.866492

DAY 19

11 August — Crossing Etosha

Okaukuejo → Halali → Etosha Pan Lookout → Fort Namutoni → Namutoni Gate / von Lindequist Gate → Mushara Lodge

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:20 / 18:39	min 7–12 °C · max 27–31 °C	200 km	When the camp opens	Landscapes and sightings in Etosha.	Mushara Lodge – DBB

DAY BRIEFING

Today we cross Etosha from west to east on a full-day safari. The route should stay flexible, but there are three anchors: Halali for a break and toilets, the immensity of the pan from an accessible viewpoint and Fort Namutoni before leaving the park for the last night near Etosha.

DAY PLAN

opening of the camp	**Okaukuejo** Leave with packed breakfast and fuel range
morning	**Okaukuejo → Halali** Flexible safari along open tracks
11:30–13:00	**Halali** Toilets, rest, waterhole and picnic lunch
13:00–15:30	**Halali Pan Lookout / Namutoni** Continue according to sightings and schedule
15:30–16:30	**Fort Namutoni** Brief cultural stop and toilets
until around 17:30	**Namutoni Gate / von Lindequist Gate** Leave the park with ample margin
late afternoon	**Mushara Lodge** Check-in and included dinner





DAY 19

Flexible navigation and margin

11 August — Crossing Etosha to Mushara

FLEXIBLE NAVIGATION AND MARGIN

Before leaving, confirm at Okaukuejo: opening and closing times; open roads and current detours; status of the connection to Halali; 4x4 range; condition of the Pan Lookout; packed breakfast. Do not rely on an old fixed itinerary. If there are detours in the Gemsbokvlakte or Salvadora area, follow the signs and instructions received at the camp.

HALALI

Halali lies roughly halfway along the crossing and is the day's main operational stop. Use the camp for: toilets; picnic lunch; break during the hottest hours; camp waterhole; fuel only if available and if needed.

ETOSHA PAN LOOKOUT

The Pan Lookout lets you approach the white surface of Etosha Pan and grasp its scale. The name Etosha is usually interpreted as "great white place". Visit only if the access is open and there is margin sufficient. It is a scenic priority, but it does not justify compromising the park exit.

FORT NAMUTONI

Fort Namutoni is the main cultural stop inside Etosha. The site began as a German police post and a veterinary control associated with the Red Line. The original fort was destroyed during the Battle of Namutoni, in 1904, and later rebuilt.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

0908-09	**Okaukuejo Rest Camp Namibia**	-19.179126, 15.919134
1108-02	**Halali Rest Camp Namibia**	-19.034975, 16.471254
1108-03	**Etosha Pan Lookout — confirm it is open**	-18.930508, 16.487587
1108-04	**Fort Namutoni Namibia**	-18.808712, 16.940367
1108-05	**Namutoni Gate — eastern exit of Etosha**	-18.803604, 17.041905
1108-06	**Mushara Lodge Namibia**	-18.812028, 17.119403

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Only basic top-ups at the camps. Next full shop: Tsumeb (day 12).
Diesel	Refuel at Okaukuejo, Halali or Namutoni; maintain range until Tsumeb.

DAY 20

12 August — From Etosha to Waterberg

Mushara Lodge → Lake Otjikoto → Tsumeb → Hoba Meteorite → Waterberg Plateau Lodge

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:14 / 18:37	min 7–12 °C · max 26–30 °C	350 km	Recommended 08:00–08:30 Max. 08:30	Trip through the highlights geological sites up to the Waterberg.	Waterberg Plateau Lodge – DBB

DAY BRIEFING

Today we swap Etosha's savannah for the geology and red sandstones of the Waterberg. Otjikoto adds history and landscape; Tsumeb is the mandatory logistics stop; Hoba, the largest known surface meteorite, is the great scientific highlight before arriving at the lodge.

DAY PLAN

07:00–08:00	**Mushara Lodge** Breakfast included
08:00–08:30	**Departure** Head towards Tsumeb
09:30–10:15	**Lake Otjikoto** Short visit
10:45–12:00	**Tsumeb** Shopping, fuel and restrooms
13:00–14:15	**Hoba Meteorite** Visit and picnic lunch
14:15–17:30	**Hoba → Waterberg** Follow the secondary roads to the lodge
end of day	**Waterberg Plateau Lodge** Arrival, orientation and included dinner





DAY 20

Otjikoto, Hoba and arrival at Waterberg

12 August — From Etosha to Waterberg

LAKE OTJIKOTO

Otjikoto is a karst lake formed by the collapse of an underground cavity. The name in Otjiherero means approximately "deep hole". In June 1915, German troops threw weapons and military equipment into the lake before surrendering to South African forces, making it also a site associated with the history of the First World War World Heritage in Namibia.

HOBA METEORITE

Hoba is the largest known meteorite on Earth's surface. It is composed mainly of iron and nickel, weighs approximately 60 tonnes and fell less than 80,000 years ago. Its flattened shape may have reduced the speed during atmospheric entry, avoiding the formation of a large crater.

TSUMEB · FINAL TOP-UP

Tsumeb is the last opportunity for a full supermarket before the Waterberg and the return stage. Buy only: 2 picnic lunches: 13 and 14 August; water, ice, fruit, snacks and fresh produce; drinks and consumables for the last days; snacks for the trip and flight, if needed.

ARRIVAL AT WATERBERG

The Waterberg rises as a red sandstone plateau above the surrounding plains. The difference in altitude creates various habitats and a greater plant diversity than the drier areas crossed earlier. At arrival, keep the late afternoon simple.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

1108-06	**Mushara Lodge Namibia**	-18.812028, 17.119403
1208-02	**Lake Otjikoto Namibia**	-19.194450, 17.550755
1208-03	**Shoprite Tsumeb Namibia**	-19.248008, 17.707577
1208-05	**Fuel Station Tsumeb Namibia**	-19.237938, 17.710010
1208-06	**Hoba Meteorite Namibia**	-19.593080, 17.934535
1208-07	**Waterberg Plateau Lodge Namibia**	-20.483807, 17.299432

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Shopping in Tsumeb: 2 lunches (13 and 14 Aug) + fresh produce, drinks and final consumables.
Diesel	Fill up in Tsumeb without fail — ~350 km to Waterberg/Otjiwarongo.

DAY 21

13 August — Walking with rhinos at Waterberg

Waterberg Plateau Lodge Rhino Tracking on Foot flexible afternoon

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:15 / 18:37	min 6–11 °C · max 25–29 °C	0 km (to be confirmed locally)	To be confirmed with the lodge	Tracking / sighting of rhinos on foot at Waterberg.	Waterberg Plateau Lodge – DBB

DAY BRIEFING

Today the main experience takes place on foot and at the tracker's pace. Rhino Tracking requires silence, attention and respect for instructions; afterwards the afternoon is deliberately flexible between rest, the History Path and a short trail.

DAY PLAN

08:00, to be confirmed	**Rhino Tracking on Foot** Priority guided activity
after the activity	**Lodge** Late breakfast or lunch, depending on schedule
early afternoon	**Waterberg** Rest and pool
late afternoon	**Light choice** History Path, short trail or continue resting
night	**Lodge** Dinner included





DAY 21

Rhino Tracking on Foot

13 August — Walking with rhinos at Waterberg

RHINO TRACKING ON FOOT

Tracking looks for rhinos and other animals on foot, accompanied by an experienced tracker. The experience does not consist only of finding the animal: it includes reading tracks, vegetation, wind, sounds and recent signs.

FLEXIBLE AFTERNOON

After tracking, there is no need to add another demanding activity.

HISTORY PATH

The History Path is a short option to better understand the occupation and history of the region, suitable if the group still wants to walk.

SHORT TRAIL OR VIEWPOINT

Waterberg Wilderness has marked trails with views over the valley and the plateau. Choose only one route short, depending on energy and local guidance.

FAUNA OF THIS TERRITORY



Black rhino



White rhino

ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

1208-07	**Waterberg Plateau Lodge Namibia** -20.483807, 17.299432

DAY 22

14 August — From Waterberg to Daan Viljoen

Waterberg → Otjiwarongo → Okahandja → Daan Viljoen Lodge

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:14 / 18:36	min 6–11 °C · max 24–29 °C	310 km	Recommended 11:00 Max. 11:00	Visit the market of the Woodcarvers in Okahandja.	Daan Viljoen Lodge – DBB

DAY BRIEFING

The last long drive starts with a choice: a morning walk on the plateau only if you finish early, or a relaxed departure after breakfast. Otjiwarongo provides fuel and toilets; Okahandja offers the last efficient cultural stop before reaching Daan Viljoen.

DAY PLAN

08:00–11:00	**Waterberg** Optional Plateau Hike decided locally, or a relaxed breakfast and earlier departure
around 11:00	**Departure with hike** Start the drive south
12:30–13:30	**Otjiwarongo** Fuel, restrooms and picnic lunch
15:00–16:00	**Okahandja** Woodcarvers Market only if there is margin
17:00–18:00	**Daan Viljoen Lodge** Arrival in daylight and included dinner





DAY 22

Plateau Hike, Okahandja and arrival at Daan Viljoen

14 August — From Waterberg to Daan Viljoen

OKAHANDJA AND MBANGURA WOODCARVERS MARKET

Okahandja has strong historical importance for the Herero people and remains associated with the memory of leaders and historical events of Namibian history. The Mbangura Woodcarvers Market offers sculptures, masks and wood carving.

ARRIVAL AT DAAN VILJOEN

Daan Viljoen sits in the hills west of Windhoek and offers a gentle transition between the road and the city. At arrival, keep the end of the day free. The visit to Windhoek is for the next day and may be shortened if the group prefer to enjoy the lodge.

TWO WAYS TO START

The Plateau Hike gives you elevated views over the plains and helps you understand the geology of the plateau. It usually starts at 08:00 and lasts about 2–3 hours. The decision will be made locally, depending on availability, conditions and group energy.

OTJIWARONGO

Use Otjiwarongo as a technical stop: fill up the three 4x4s; use the toilet; eat the picnic bought in Tsumeb; confirm the estimated arrival time. A full shop is not needed.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

1208-07	**Waterberg Plateau Lodge Namibia**	-20.483807, 17.299432
1408-02	**Fuel Station Otjiwarongo Namibia**	-20.453829, 16.652956
1408-03	**Mbangura Woodcarvers Market Okahandja**	-21.974279, 16.911880
1408-04	**Daan Viljoen Lodge Namibia**	-22.537778, 16.945697

FUEL & SUPPLIES

Meals	Arrange lunch for 15 Aug and final snacks/drinks; last-minute shopping in Otjiwarongo if needed.
Diesel	Fill up at Otjiwarongo — ~310 km to Windhoek/Daan Viljoen.

DAY 23

15 August — A cultural day in Windhoek

Daan Viljoen Lodge · Windhoek historic centre · optional lunch and markets · Daan Viljoen

SUNRISE / SUNSET	TEMPERATURE	BASE PLAN	DEPARTURE TIME	DAY'S AIM	ACCOMMODATION
07:17 / 18:37	min 7–11 °C · max 23–27 °C	50 km	Recommended at dawn	Cultural visit to Windhoek.	Daan Viljoen Lodge – DBB

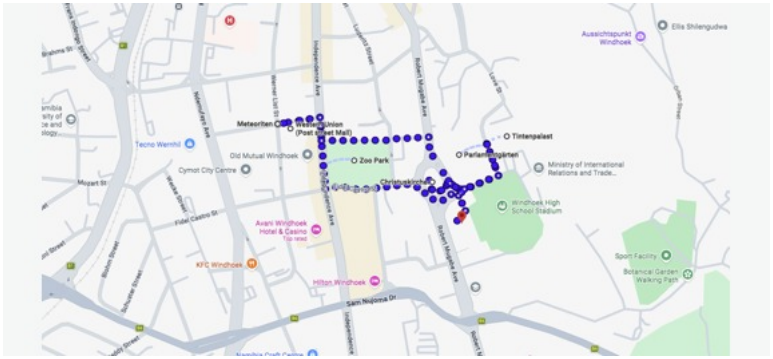
DAY BRIEFING

The last full day is deliberately modular. The core is a short walk through the historic centre and lunch in Windhoek; afterwards the group chooses between crafts and final shopping or an early return to rest in the Daan Viljoen hills.

DAY PLAN

07:30–09:00	**Daan Viljoen** Breakfast and a quiet morning
09:30–10:30	**Driving / parking** Head to central Windhoek
10:30–12:30	**Historic centre** Short walking loop
12:30–14:00	**Windhoek** Lunch in town
14:00–15:30	**Afternoon choice** Craft Centre / final shopping, or return to Daan Viljoen
late afternoon	**Daan Viljoen** Rest and preparation for departure
night	**Lodge** Dinner included





DAY 23

Walking tour of central Windhoek

15 August — Windhoek, tailored to the group

CHRISTUSKIRCHE

The Lutheran church, inaugurated in the early 20th century, combines Neo-Romanesque, Gothic and Art Nouveau elements. Its elevated position makes it one of the most recognisable landmarks in Windhoek.

PARLIAMENT GARDENS AND TINTENPALAST

View the exterior of parliament and the surrounding gardens, understanding the concentration of political institutions in the centre of the capital. The Parliament Gardens may be closed to the public; the circuit does not depend on entrance to the gardens.

INDEPENDENCE AVENUE AND POST STREET MALL

The central axis shows contemporary Windhoek. At Post Street Mall, fragments of the meteorites of Gibeon, from one of the largest meteorite showers known. Do the walk on foot only in the areas comfortable for the group and keep belongings out of sight in the 4x4s.

CONTINUE IN WINDHOEK

The Namibia Craft Centre, housed in the former breweries, brings together crafts, jewellery, textiles and other products Namibians. It can be combined with coffee or lunch and works as an organised alternative to the street stalls. At Saturday, the published official hours end at 16:00; ideally arrive before 15:00.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

1408-04	**Daan Viljoen Lodge Namibia**	-22.537778, 16.945697
1508-02	**Christuskirche Windhoek**	-22.567718, 17.087082
1508-03	**Parliament Gardens Windhoek**	-22.567133, 17.087897
1508-04	**Post Street Mall Windhoek**	-22.566367, 17.083030
1508-05	**Namibia Craft Centre Windhoek**	-22.572211, 17.083895

DAY 24

16 August — Returning the vehicles and departure

Daan Viljoen Lodge → AfriCar Windhoek → Hosea Kutako International Airport

SUNRISE	RETURN FLIGHT	RETURN	TRANSFER	DAY'S AIM	CHECK-IN
07:16	TAAG DT574 · 13:30	AfriCar · Windhoek	Hosea Kutako (airport)	Home again.	International · with margin

DAY BRIEFING

Today there are no visits or walks. The only priority is to check out calmly, return the three 4x4s without forgotten items and reach the airport with comfortable margin for the 13:30 DT574 flight.

DAY PLAN

06:45–07:45	**Daan Viljoen** Breakfast included
07:45–08:30	**Lodge** Check-out, loading and final inspection of the 4x4s
08:30–09:15	**Driving** Head to the AfriCar office
09:15–10:15	**AfriCar** Handover of the three vehicles and inspection
10:15–11:15	**Transfer** Head to Hosea Kutako International Airport
until around 11:15	**Airport** Check-in, immigration and security
13:30	**DT574** Departure for Luanda





DAY 24

Home again — useful recommendations

16 August — Returning the vehicles and departure

HOME AGAIN — USEFUL RECOMMENDATIONS

Opening hours are conservative. Vehicle pick-up and return take place at the AfriCar Hire office, 7 Tienie/Tinie Louw Street, Northern Industrial Area, Windhoek.

BEFORE LEAVING THE LODGE

Check each 4x4 separately: fridge empty and switched off as instructed; rubbish and food removed; seats, boxes and compartments checked; accessories, chairs, tables and kitchen gathered; fuel at the required level; quick photos of the exterior, interior and dashboard; documents, keys and proofs accessible; hand luggage and passports outside the checked luggage.

VEHICLE HANDOVER

Set aside time to inspect the three 4x4s. Jointly record any damage already identified and confirm the handover accessories. After returning at the AfriCar office, transport to the airport will be by transfer. Do not schedule any stop between AfriCar and Hosea Kutako.

AIRPORT

TAAG flight DT574 departs Windhoek at 13:30. Arrive early enough for international check-in, luggage, immigration and security.



ESSENTIAL NAVIGATION

1408-04	**Daan Viljoen Lodge Namibia**	-22.537778, 16.945697
1608-02	**AfriCar Hire**	-22.534778, 17.074127
1608-03	**Hosea Kutako International Airport**	-22.487344, 17.463793

APPENDICES

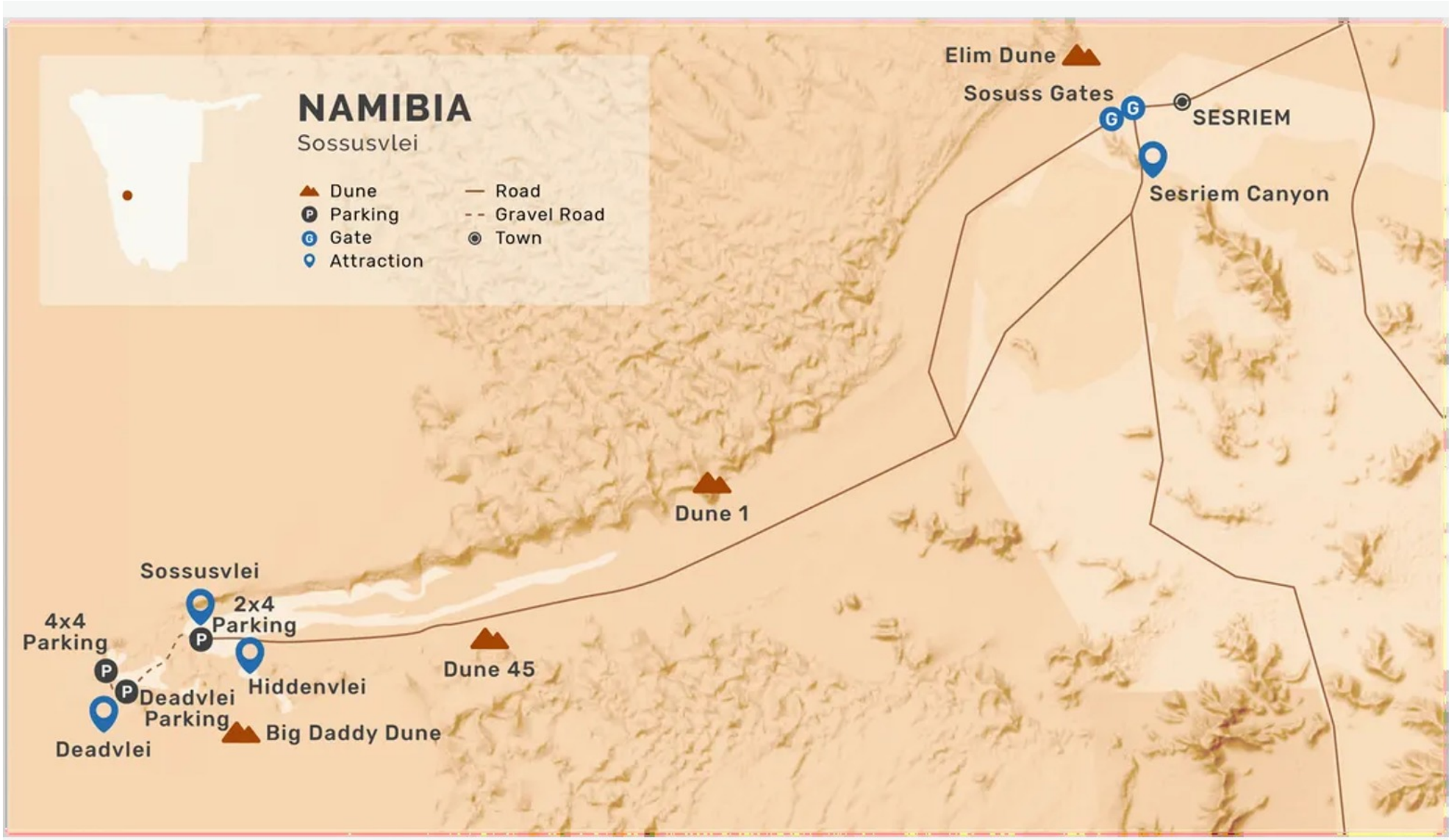
Appendices

Maps, quick references, budget, checklists and useful contacts

SPECIAL MAP

Sossusvlei and Deadvlei

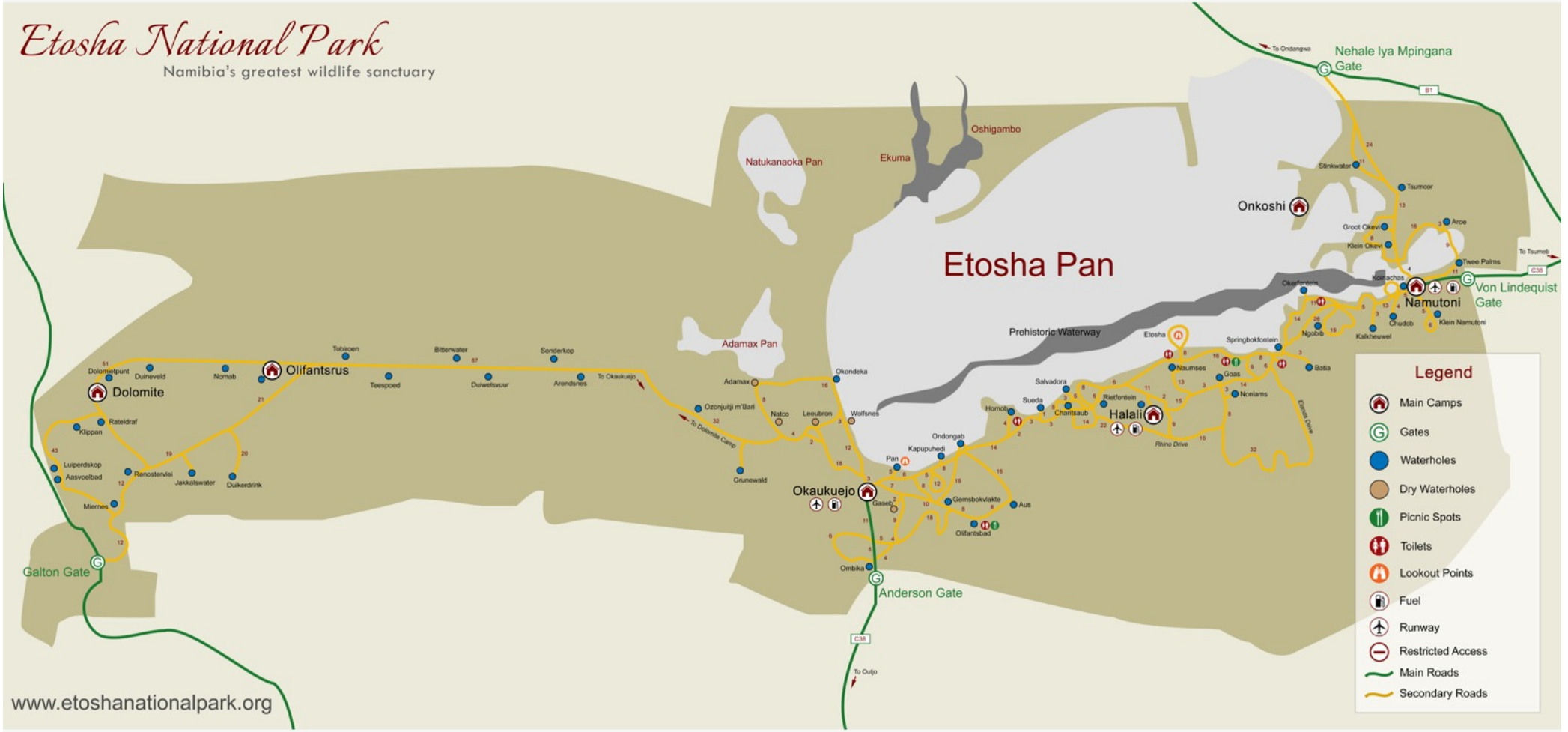
Internal map for reference on 2–3 August



SPECIAL MAP

Etosha · full view

Roads, camps, gates and waterholes



SPECIAL MAP

Etosha · west sector

Detailed map for reference during safaris



SPECIAL MAP

Etosha · east sector

Detailed map for the Okaukuejo–Mushara crossing



APPENDIX

Approximate costs

Practical reference for use on the trip

Indicative values checked on 7 June 2026.

APPROXIMATE EXCHANGE RATE

Reference	Value
Indicative rate	€1 ≈ N$19,09
N$100	€5,24
N$250	€13,09
N$500	€26,19
N$1.000	€52,37
US$1 ≈ N$18 (to be confirmed)	—

The Namibian dollar (NAD) is pegged at parity with the South African rand (ZAR): N$1 = R1.

FUEL AND MEALS

Item	NAD	EUR approx.
Diesel 50 ppm · Walvis Bay	N$28.26/litre	€1.48/litre
Simple meal at a restaurant	N$120–200	€6–10
Coffee / drink	N$30–60	€1,50–3
Fuel estimate · two 4x4s	N$31.600–39.850	€1.655–2.087

APPENDIX

Approximate costs

Practical reference for use on the trip

PARKS AND PERMITS

Park	Adult/day	Vehicle/day	Where to pay	Does the operator include?
Fish River Canyon (Ai-/Ais)	N$150	N$50	Gate / reception	—
Namib-Naukluft · Sesriem/Sossusvlei	N$150	N$50	Sesriem gate	—
Namib-Naukluft · Sandwich Harbour	N$150	N$50	MEFT permit (in advance)	Yes, guided tour
Etosha	N$150	N$50	Gate / camp	—
Waterberg Plateau	N$150	N$50	Park reception	—

Indicative MEFT fees, valid for 24 h and paid at each day/gate (children and vehicles have their own fees; confirm at the gates). Sandwich Harbour and Welwitschia Drive require a MEFT permit obtained in advance (the NWR does not issue them); on guided tours the operator handles the permit — confirm when booking.

APPENDIX

Budget

Practical reference for use on the trip

Estimates for five people and two 4x4s. Exchange rate and fuel checked on 7 June 2026. Conversions and unit prices are in the Approximate Costs appendix.

FUEL ESTIMATE · TWO 4x4s

Scenario	Mileage	Consumption	Total NAD	Total EUR
Conservative	4,400 km per 4x4	13 L/100 km	N$31.600	€1.655
Pessimistic	4,800 km per 4x4	15 L/100 km	N$39.850	€2.087

BASE BUDGET

Category	NAD estimate	EUR estimate
Fuel · two 4x4s	N$31.600–39.850	€1.655–2.087
Food, supermarkets and everyday expenses	N$30.000–35.000	€1.572–1.833
Parks, monuments and entrance fees	N$6.000–9.000	€314–471
Planned base total	N$67.600–83.850	€3.541–4.391
Optional activities · outside the base budget	up to N$10,000	up to €524

PAYMENT STRATEGY

Means	Recommended amount	Use
Operational cash in NAD	N$15,000 · about €786	Remote fuel, small entry fees, markets, tips and card terminal failures
Revolut and cards	Main means of payment	Fuel, supermarkets, restaurants and activities
Physical reserve in EUR	€1.500	Emergency; do not exchange everything on arrival

Bring approximately €2,300 in physical cash equivalent: exchange about €800 for N$15,000 in Windhoek and keep €1,500 separate as a reserve. Assess cash use over the trip and restock only in a large town, such as Swakopmund, if needed.

Use at least two physical cards, stored separately. When a terminal offers conversion to euros, always choose to pay in NAD.

APPENDIX

Trip Checklist

Practical reference for use on the trip

Essential preparations that should be completed before departure. Packing, local shopping and vehicle inspection are covered in their respective lists.

DOCUMENTS AND ENTRY

☐ Valid passports, with sufficient validity and blank pages.

☐ Visas or eVisa issued, where applicable.

☐ International Driving Permits issued for all drivers.

HEALTH AND INSURANCE

☐ Valid travel insurance, including medical assistance and repatriation.

☐ Travel medicine consultation completed and recommendations addressed.

CASH

☐ Revolut cards loaded, with physical cards, PIN and limits checked.

☐ EUR and/or USD ordered to take as an emergency reserve.

The recommended EUR/USD amount and payment strategy will be set in the budget appendix.

OFFLINE NAVIGATION AND DOCUMENTS

☐ Maps and navigation files installed and tested on the chosen devices.

☐ Digital copies available offline of: passports; driving licences and International Driving Permits; travel insurance; vouchers and bookings; flight tickets; roadbooks and emergency contacts.

Keep the documents on more than one phone and in an accessible cloud location.

AIRPORT TRANSPORT

☐ Transfers and airport transport confirmed, including: transport to the departure airport; transfer from Windhoek airport to AfriCar; final AfriCar transfer to the airport; transport on the return home.

APPENDIX

Packing Checklist

Practical reference for use on the trip

HAND LUGGAGE · PER PERSON

- ☐ Passport, visa, tickets and boarding passes.
- ☐ Driving licence and International Driving Permit, where applicable.
- ☐ Travel insurance and essential contacts.
- ☐ Cards, cash reserve and digital copies of documents.
- ☐ Phone, cable, usual medication and valuables.
- ☐ One change of clothes, underwear and a warm layer.

CLOTHING AND FOOTWEAR · PER PERSON

- ☐ T-shirts and light shirts (10)
- ☐ Light, comfortable trousers (2)
- ☐ Shorts (2)
- ☐ Underwear and pairs of socks (10)
- ☐ Warm pyjamas (1)
- ☐ Fleece (1)
- ☐ Merino jumper or equivalent thermal layer (1)
- ☐ Windbreaker (optional)
- ☐ Beanie, light gloves and buff/scarf (1 set)
- ☐ Hat or cap (1)
- ☐ Swimwear (1)
- ☐ Clothes for dinner at the lodges (1 set)
- ☐ Walking boots or shoes already worn in (1 pair)
- ☐ Trainers or light shoes (1 pair)
- ☐ Flip-flops or sandals (1 pair)

HEALTH, HYGIENE AND PROTECTION · PER PERSON

- ☐ Enough personal medication and a travel pharmacy.
- ☐ Personal hygiene items, insect repellent and high-factor sunscreen.
- ☐ Lip balm with sun protection and sunglasses.
- ☐ One bath towel per person, especially needed at Spitzkoppe.
- ☐ Small face towel: ideally one per person.

PERSONAL EQUIPMENT AND ACCESSORIES

- ☐ Small backpack and reusable water bottle.
- ☐ Multi-purpose cloth, tea towel and clothes pegs.
- ☐ Bags for dirty laundry.
- ☐ Personal gluten-free foods or items difficult to replace locally.
- ☐ Two to three reusable Tupperware boxes.
- ☐ Strong tape and cable ties.
- ☐ Pharmacy, notebook and pens, small sewing kit and small games, as needed.

Packing Checklist

Practical reference for use on the trip

TECHNOLOGY, NAVIGATION AND PHOTOGRAPHY · PER 4x4

- ☐ Phones, cables, optional power banks and car USB chargers.
- ☐ Adapters compatible with Type D and Type M sockets.
- ☐ Phone holders, maps and offline documents.
- ☐ Headlamps or torches and binoculars.
- ☐ Camera, lenses, telephoto and dust bags, if wanted.
- ☐ Drone and required documentation/authorisation, if applicable.

APPENDIX

First Supermarket Shop

Practical reference for use on the trip

Basic items, bought once at the start of the trip and kept in both 4x4s. Shopping quantities are in the Fuel & Supplies section of each day. First check the contents of the boxes kitchen equipment provided with the 4x4s.

CLEANING, HYGIENE AND CONSERVATION

- ☐ Washing-up liquid (small pack)
- ☐ Sponges (at least one per 4x4)
- ☐ Kitchen/multi-purpose cloth (if not already brought)
- ☐ Kitchen roll and tissues
- ☐ Toilet paper and wet wipes
- ☐ Cleaning wipes
- ☐ Reusable bags, zip bags and strong rubbish bags
- ☐ Laundry detergent for hand washing (small pack)
- ☐ Hand sanitiser (distribute among the 4x4s)

KITCHEN AND PICNIC

- ☐ Aluminium foil and cling film
- ☐ Napkins
- ☐ Matches and lighter

CONDIMENTS AND PANTRY

- ☐ Salt, pepper, olive oil (small bottle) and vinegar
- ☐ Sugar and honey
- ☐ Coffee (regular and decaf) and tea
- ☐ UHT / long-life milk
- ☐ Tinned food (tuna, pulses or equivalent)
- ☐ Pasta or rice
- ☐ Dried fruit and compote

WATER

- ☐ Initial drinking water (distribute among the 4x4s)
- ☐ Water containers (ensure range between shops)

APPENDIX

Useful Words and Short Phrases for Namibia

Practical reference for use on the trip

Afrikaans is understood almost everywhere on the route. The phrases below cover the most common travel situations.

GREETINGS AND COURTESY

English	Afrikaans
Hello	Hallo
Good morning	Goeie môre
Good afternoon / good morning	Goeie dag
Good evening, when greeting	Goeie naand
Thank you.	Dankie
Thank you very much.	Baie dankie
Please	Asseblief
Excuse me / pardon me	Verskoon my
Goodbye	Totsiens
Do you speak English?	Praat u Engels?
I don't understand	Ek verstaan nie
Could you repeat that, please?	Kan u dit herhaal, asseblief?
Can you help us?	Kan u ons help?

APPENDIX

Useful Words and Short Phrases for Namibia

Practical reference for use on the trip

CONVERSATION

English	Afrikaans
How are you?	Hoe gaan dit?
I'm well, thank you	Dit gaan goed, dankie
What is your name?	Wat is u naam?
My name is…	My naam is…
Where are you from?	Waar kom u vandaan?
We are from the UK	Ons kom van Portugal
We are really enjoying Namibia	Ons geniet Namibië baie
How do you say this in your language?	Hoe sê u dit in u taal?
May I take a photo?	Mag ek 'n foto neem?
Thank you for your help.	Dankie vir u hulp

APPENDIX

Useful Words and Short Phrases for Namibia

Practical reference for use on the trip

FOOD, RESTAURANTS AND SUPERMARKETS

English	Afrikaans
We have a booking under the name Santos	Ons het 'n bespreking onder die naam Santos
Do you have a table for five people?	Het u 'n tafel vir vyf mense?
We need a gluten-free meal	Ons benodig 'n glutenvrye maaltyd
Does this contain gluten?	Bevat dit gluten?
I am allergic to…	Ek is allergies vir…
Still water / sparkling water	Stilwater / vonkelwater
Can we order a packed breakfast / lunch?	Kan ons 'n ontbytpakkie / middagete-pakkie bestel?
The bill, please	Die rekening, asseblief
Can we pay by card?	Kan ons per kaart betaal?
Where is the nearest supermarket?	Waar is die naaste supermark?

DIRECTIONS AND ROAD

English	Afrikaans
Is this the road to…?	Is dit die pad na…?
How far is it…?	Hoe ver is…?
Is the road open?	Is die pad oop?
Is this road suitable for a 4x4?	Is hierdie pad geskik vir 'n 4x4?
Where is the nearest petrol station?	Waar is die naaste vulstasie?
Diesel, full tank, please	Diesel, maak vol, asseblief
Can you check the tyre pressure?	Kan u die banddruk nagaan?
Where is the bathroom?	Waar is die toilet?
Can you show us on the map?	Kan u dit op die kaart wys?

APPENDIX

Useful Words and Short Phrases for Namibia

Practical reference for use on the trip

VEHICLE AND WORKSHOP

English	Afrikaans
We have a flat tyre	Ons het 'n pap band
The vehicle won't start	Die voertuig wil nie aanskakel nie
We need a mechanic	Ons het 'n werktuigkundige nodig
Where is the nearest workshop?	Waar is die naaste werkswinkel?
Can you help us contact AfriCar?	Kan u ons help om AfriCar te kontak?
Is there mobile coverage here?	Is daar selfoonsein hier?

HEALTH

English	Afrikaans
We need medical assistance	Ons het mediese hulp nodig
Where is the nearest clinic / hospital?	Waar is die naaste kliniek / hospitaal?
Please call an ambulance	Bel asseblief 'n ambulans
I don't feel well.	Ek voel nie goed nie
I have pain here	Ek het hier pyn
I am taking this medication	Ek neem hierdie medikasie
It is urgent	Dit is dringend

APPENDIX

Useful Words and Short Phrases for Namibia

Practical reference for use on the trip

LODGE AND ACTIVITIES

English	Afrikaans
What time is breakfast / dinner?	Hoe laat is ontbyt / aandete?
What time does the activity start?	Hoe laat begin die aktiwiteit?
Where is the meeting point?	Waar is die ontmoetingspunt?
Can we do this trail without a guide?	Kan ons hierdie roete sonder 'n gids stap?
Is there a laundry service?	Is daar 'n wasgoeddiens?
Is there Wi-Fi?	Is daar Wi-Fi?

GREETINGS IN OTHER NAMIBIAN LANGUAGES

There is no single indigenous language common to the whole route. The symbols ! and // represent clicks; it is best to ask a speaker to teach the pronunciation.

English	Language	Expression	Where to listen
Good morning	Khoekhoegowab	!Gâi //goas	South and Damaraland (Nama/Damara)
How are you?	Khoekhoegowab	Matisa?	South and Damaraland
Thank you.	Khoekhoegowab	Aio	South and Damaraland
Goodbye	Khoekhoegowab	!Gâise !gû re	South and Damaraland
Hello	Oshiwambo	Wa aluka!	North, Etosha and Tsumeb
How are you?	Oshiwambo	Ou li tutu nawa?	North, Etosha and Tsumeb
Thank you.	Oshiwambo	Nda pandula	North, Etosha and Tsumeb
Goodbye / go well	Oshiwambo	Enda nawa	North, Etosha and Tsumeb

APPENDIX

Useful Contacts

Practical reference for use on the trip

EMERGENCY AND ASSISTANCE

Contact	Number / information
Namibian Police · emergency	10111
Travel insurance · 24h assistance	Heymondo · policy 2093372 · 24h assistance +351 309 739 803 · contacto@heymondo.pt · Heymondo App
Info-Namibia	+264 61 220 563 · emergency +264 81 258 7682
AfriCar · assistance	+264 81 124 1075

ACTIVITIES · WALVIS BAY AND SWAKOPMUND

Date	Activity	Logistics	Contact
4 Aug	Kayaking · Eco Marine Kayak Tours	Schedule 08:00–12:15 · present 07:45 · return ~13:00 · no lunch	booking via agency
4 Aug	Sandwich Harbour 4x4 · Sandwich Harbour 4x4	Check-in 08:15 · return ~13:00 · no lunch	booking via agency
5 Aug	Living Desert · Living Desert Adventures	Pick-up 08:00	booking via agency

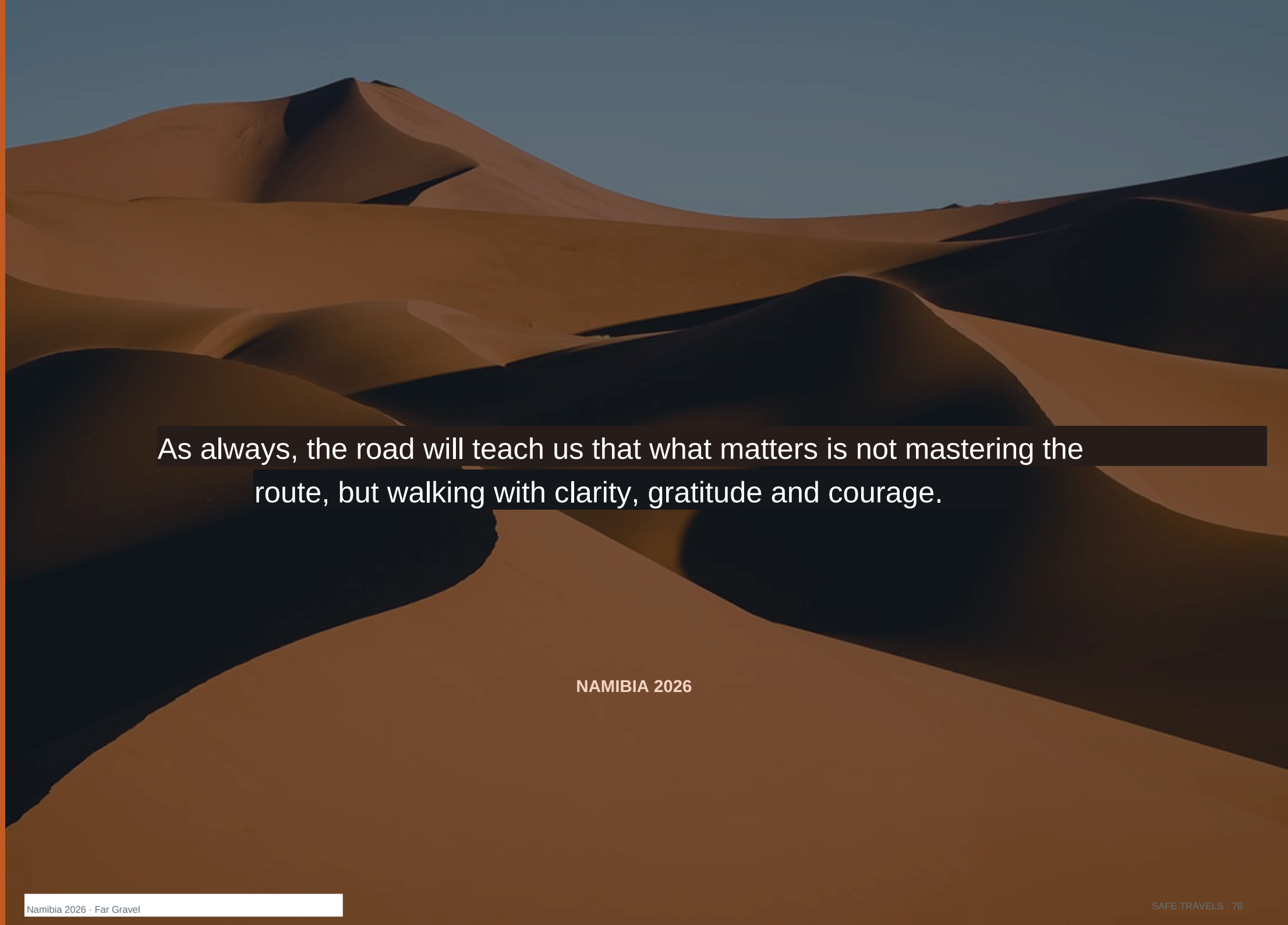
APPENDIX

Useful Contacts

Practical reference for use on the trip

ACCOMMODATION

Dates	Accommodation	Nights	Board basis	Contact
24 Jul	Hotel Thule	1	BB	+264 61 371 950
25–27 Jul	Kalahari Anib Lodge	2	DBB	+264 84 000 7335 / 7336
27–29 Jul	Fish River Lodge	2	DBB	+264 63 683 005
29–31 Jul	Desert Horse Inn · Klein-Aus Vista	2	BB	+264 63 258 116 / 258 021
31 Jul–2 Aug	BüllsPort Lodge & Farm	2	DBB	+264 63 293 371
2–3 Aug	Sossus Dune Lodge	1	DBB	+264 63 693 256 / +264 81 304 4020
3–5 Aug	Jetty Self-Catering Units	2	SC	+264 81 676 1077
5–7 Aug	Spitzkoppe Cabin Camp	2	SC · bring towels	+264 81 850 2566
7–9 Aug	Huab Lodge	2	DBB	+264 67 312 070
9–11 Aug	Okaukuejo Rest Camp	2	BB	+264 67 229 800
11–12 Aug	Mushara Lodge	1	DBB	+264 67 229 106
12–14 Aug	Waterberg Plateau Lodge	2	DBB	+264 67 687 018
14–16 Aug	Daan Viljoen Lodge	2	DBB	+264 83 323 2393



As always, the road will teach us that what matters is not mastering the route, but walking with clarity, gratitude and courage.

NAMIBIA 2026